

KILLA BEE

Written by
Ruth Sewell

Inspired by the life of Bryony Tyrell

Yellow Revisions
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Silence. Extreme close up on the eyes of YOUNG BRY TYRELL (20s). Rain falls on her, trickles down her face. Her eyes close. At peace.

1 EXT. CLIFTON SUSPENSION BRIDGE - DAY

1

Valentine's Day.

We float above the River Avon as the opening bars of The Manic Street Preachers' 'A Design for Life' drifts up to us on the wind. Far below, we see a figure standing on the outer ledge of Bristol's Clifton Suspension Bridge.

Young Bry, (hollow eyed and emaciated, like she hasn't eaten in years) stands on the edge of the bridge. The river rushes beneath her, rain batters her face. The sound of the river fades up to a roar, drowning out the music.

CUT TO:

2 INT. MMA VENUE - NIGHT

2

12 years later. Extreme close up on the eyes of BRY TYRELL (now in her 30s). Her eyes are wide, almost bulging, consumed with terror. Time slows. The rush of the river continues, muted.

As we pull back, rotating 90 degrees, we see that Bry is being pressed into the ground. Her heavily tattooed arm is bent up behind her, about to break.

Suddenly, time speeds and vision blurs as Bry breaks out of the arm-lock and smashes her elbow into her OPPONENT's nose. The sound of the river returns full force, and we realise it's become the sound of the crowd. The packed stadium roars.

The women stagger to their feet and circle one another. Her opponent's nose pours blood but she looks focussed, mean, ready to kill.

Bry is... smiling.

Time slows as we hear -

BRY (V.O.)

I've been so lucky to have had such
fantastic times in my life.

Suddenly, Bry lands a brutal punch and leaps onto her opponent's chest, pounding her broken nose relentlessly with her fists.

Bry's face is calm, almost cold, as she savagely destroys the other woman's face. Blood spatters the mat. Again, time slows.

BRY (V.O.)
At times, I've been so happy I
could explode.

Finally, the REFEREE stops the fight.

Bry throws her hands up in blissful celebration, the crowd goes wild. She starts walking a lap of honor around the ring, but then sees her Opponent still lying broken on the canvas.

Bry's expression changes to one of intense guilt. She immediately runs over and offers her hand to her defeated rival, pulling her up off the ground and into a heartfelt hug.

BRY (V.O.)
Believe me, if I could, I would
stay, but I would just bring others
down with me.

Bry is shaking from the adrenalin. She holds her opponent for what seems like a long time, breathless, elated, almost tearful.

BRY (V.O.)
I want to go now before the
memories fade and while there is
still a part of me here.

The REFEREE is trying to get her attention, but she's too caught up with her Opponent to notice, examining her bloodied face. Slightly apologetically, Bry pops her nose back into place.

The Ref grabs her hand and raises it.

BRY (V.O.)
I know you can't forgive me, but
please let me go.

The crowd roars: "Killa Bee, Killa Bee, Killa Bee!"

Bry takes in the adulation from the room and smiles: victorious.

CROWD
Killa Bee, Killa Bee, Killa Bee!

She closes her eyes, savouring the moment.

3

EXT. CLIFTON SUSPENSION BRIDGE - DAY [FLASHBACK]

3

Young Bry stands on the bridge, eyes closed in peace. Wind catches her hair. She breathes. The crowd's chant echoes over this scene, in time with the Manic Street Preachers.

CROWD

(faintly)

Killa Bee, Killa Bee, Killa Bee!

BRY (V.O.)

All my love forever and ever. B.

Bry's weight shifts forward but before she falls -

CUT TO BLACK.

KILLA BEE

SUPER: INSPIRED BY THE LIFE OF BRYONY TYRELL.

4

INT. HOSPITAL, MAIN WARD - DAY [MONTAGE]

4

Follow Bry, in full nurses' uniform, through an intense work shift. We never see her face. Instead, we follow her from behind and see what she sees.

- A FAMILY around the bedside of an ELDERLY PATIENT (90s) who, talks Bry up to her family.

- A PANICKED JUNIOR NURSE (22) accosts her in a empty cubicle to ask a barrage of questions. Bry, calm and confident, reassures her.

- Another ICU PATIENT (30s) who has been in a traffic accident. Bry and the Junior Nurse make him more comfortable.

- A DISTRESSED PATIENT (50s) hurls abuse at Bry but she manages to calm them down.

- Bry and another NURSE move a bodybag from a bed to a trolley. A 'Get Well Soon' balloon sags in the background.

- Bry comforts a DISTRESSED FAMILY MEMBER (70s) who is visiting their loved one in the ICU. They hug her.

- Night. A rare moment of stillness and solitude in an empty bay, as Bry scrubs her hands. We finally see her face in the mirror, Now we see the full extent of Bry's injuries, which have developed into their full purple pomp.

- Bry is revealed from the front now, as she closes the curtain.

5 INT. HOSPITAL, NURSES' STATION - NIGHT

5

A more senior nurse, FRAN, (50s, prim, Bry's supervisor) pulls her aside.

FRAN

Why are you still here? You stopped getting paid three hours ago.

BRY

I don't need to rush back.

Fran, perplexed, suddenly thinks she's figured it out. She is serious to the point of parody as she gently broaches an awkward subject.

FRAN

Bry, is he hurting you? Is that why you don't want to go home? I've got a number you can call-

Bry is embarrassed. Her gentle nature shines through, forming a strange contrast with the savage alter-ego we met in the cage. She interjects, smiling apologetically.

BRY

No, no. Fran, it's... it's not what it looks like-

Another nurse, trying to embarrass Bry, cuts her off.

INTI

She's just got some weird kinks, Fran. Don't question her, you don't want to know.

This is INTI PANCHAL, (30s) Bry's best friend. Bry can't help but laugh, then doubles over in pain, clutching her ribs.

BRY

Sorry. I'm fine. It was... consensual.

Fran, appalled, shakes her head and leaves.

BRY (CONT'D)

(to Inti)

Dick.

They cackle conspiratorially.

6

INT. DUKE OF WELLINGTON PUB - NIGHT

6

After work, we find the nursing team (including Bry and Inti) in the pub, blowing off steam. A couple of recently qualified registrar doctors have joined them, MARK UBOVIC and JANINE NGUYEN (late 20s).

MARK

So, Florence Nightingale won
another cage-fight this weekend?

JANINE

It says a lot about the state of
NHS nursing that you chose MMA as
your part-time job. You must be
good if you've gone pro.

BRY

(smiling)

I don't know. I just enjoy it.

INTI

Fuck sake, stop with the false
modesty!

BRY

I'm alright.

INTI

(to Janine)

She's never been defeated-

BRY

I lost that fight in-

Inti shushes her.

INTI

-including against me. Such a shit
mate. Couldn't let me have one win.

BRY

Awh. Your jealousy means more than
your support ever could.

Mark cuts in. He clearly wants to keep Bry's attention on
him.

MARK

My mate's a fan. Said you're one of
the best female fighters in the UK.

INTI
Not one of the best. She is the
best.

MARK
Hmm yeah. That's kind of like...
'Britain's Tallest Dwarf'.

Janine and Inti exchange glances. Bry flutters her eyelashes.

BRY
Oh Dr. Mark... are you... flirting
with me?

MARK
Maybe.

BRY
(smiling)
Hmm. Interesting strategy. Could
you try a more traditional
approach?

Inti and Janine smile. Bry's somehow managed to call Mark out
whilst diffusing the awkwardness.

MARK
(laughing)
Okay. How about...
(flirtatious)
What do you wear in the cage?

Bry nods, playing along with the flirtation.

BRY
Wouldn't you like to know?

MARK
Yes, yes I would.

BRY
(seductive)
Well, usually I wear really tight
vest, big baggy shorts and a
gumshield.

MARK
(laughing)
Sounds very sexy. So when can I see
you fight?

BRY
You're too late. I've retired.

MARK

Really?

BRY

(shrugging)

Better to go out on a high.

MARK

Well, in that case, I'll call my dealer.

7 INT. MONTAGE SEQUENCE [VARIOUS PUB/BAR/CLUB LOCATIONS] 7

What starts as a casual drink quickly descends into a night of debauchery.

Flashing lights jump us between locations: a punch up to the senses.

Bry's kicking drinks off tables, dancing wildly and provocatively with anyone and everyone. She and Inti spin and flip, demonstrating their martial arts prowess on the dancefloor. *

She leads the shock-troops on a mission of euphoric self-destruction.

7A EXT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE - NIGHT 7A

Bry stumbles drunkenly up the garden path.

Prelap: Suddenly, a child screams with a terrifying intensity.

8 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, SOREN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT 8

A shaft of light widens through an opening door to reveal a child's bedroom, illuminating SOREN, (7) who is sitting bolt upright in bed, screaming his lungs out.

Bry stumbles into the room in the same clothes she was wearing on her night out, makeup smudged. She drunkenly trips over a toy before clambering into bed with her son, holding him close. *
*
*

BRY

Shhhh. It's okay. It's okay.

Soren finally calms enough to take in his mother's battered face. Gently, he touches Bry's bruised eye and swollen lip. Bry flinches slightly, but smiles to reassure him.

BRY (CONT'D)

I'm okay.

He wraps his arms around her and she smiles contentedly, snuggling down with him.

9 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, SOREN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT - LATER 9

Bry's husband, TOM, (30s) appears at the door to find Bry and Soren asleep together in the single bed. He gently closes the door and his wife and son are plunged back into darkness.

10 INT. BRISTOL UNIVERSITY-- DAY [FLASHBACK] 10 *

YOUNG TOM (early 20s, but looks young for his age) stands stock still, the only person not rushing somewhere in the busy hallway. He stares in shock at his phone, from which there is a faint automated voice emanating. Raises it to his ear.

AUTOMATED VOICE

If you would like to listen to the message again, press 1. To save the message, press 2. To delete-

Tom presses 1, and the message is repeated.

YOUNG BRY

Hi Tom, I don't know if you'll remember me, we met a couple of months ago at the gym? Hope your course is going well. I just wanted to let you know that I'm pregnant. And I'm keeping it. I don't expect anything from you. Just thought it was, you know, polite to tell you. Anyway, hope you're good. Oh, this is Bryony Tyrell by the way.

A click, and then the automated message starts again.

AUTOMATED VOICE

If you would like to listen to the message again, press 1. To save, press 2...

Tom is still in shock. He stares into space. Presses 2.

Then a beaming smile of pure joy spreads across his face.

11 EXT. BEACH - DAY

11

Back in the present, Bry stares vacantly out to sea on a beautiful sunny day.

Her phone rings: 'Mum'. She hesitates, clearly not wanting to answer.

Bry's concentration is broken by a loud wail. Her youngest, Soren, and her 11 year old daughter, (still in her taekwondo uniform) JESSICA, are fighting.

Soren tries to clothes-line his sister, but he is tiny for his age and his attempted rugby tackle hits her just above the knees.

Bry cancels the call.

Jessica wrestles her brother to the ground, pinning him and slapping the paving stone next to his head. Tom makes to pull them apart.

JESSICA

One, two, three! He's out! TKO!

TOM

Jess-

Soren is furious at this indignity as Jessica leaps up and plays to an imaginary crowd, holding an invisible MMA belt aloft.

JESSICA

Loser!

Soren's bottom lip starts to go...

BRY

Hey Soren-

Bry tries to distract him, but Soren bursts into tears. She hugs him.

BRY (CONT'D)

It's okay, it's just a game!

JESSICA

Sorry, sorry, sorry! I was only joking...

Jess tickles him, making Soren laugh through the tears.

Bry hugs them both. On a hangover with a smashed-in face and suspected broken rib, parental duties feel like a nightmarish dream, but the love for her kids shines through the pain.

BRY

Race you to the red flag!

Soren wipes his eyes, interested.

BRY (CONT'D)

Girls against boys!

JESSICA

Yesssss.

SOREN

Noooo, not fair!

TOM

(to Soren)

Oh, thanks a lot!

BRY

Ready? 3, 2, 1. Go!

She sets off and the kids chase after her, Tom lagging behind.

TOM

It's slippery! Be careful!

He is roundly ignored by all three of them. They dash along the waterway, with Soren taking more risks than anyone. He trips and almost falls, but just before he does, Bry scoops him up and swings him round.

JESSICA

Mum! We were winning!

BRY

(aside to Jessica)

I was trying to push him in the sea, but he jumped into my arms!

Jessica chuckles.

SOREN

What?

BRY

Nothing!

Jessica and Bry laugh, thick as thieves. Bry's elation is cut short as she clutches her aching ribs and tries to stop laughing. She kisses the top of Soren's head over and over and then pulls Jessica in for a group hug.

BRY (CONT'D)

I wouldn't push either of you into the sea. That's how much I love you.

Tom catches up with them.

TOM

(to Bry)

If he hurts himself, you're taking him to A&E.

BRY

Soren's old enough to take himself now, isn't he?

Tom laughs, despite himself.

TOM

(affectionately)

You're the worst.

They start walking again, Soren between Bry and Tom. Bry tries to take Soren's hand.

BRY

Swingies?

Soren retracts his hand, slightly awkwardly.

SOREN

Nah, that's for babies.

BRY

You are my baby!

SOREN

No, I'm not!

The cheerful ring of the ice cream van.

SOREN (CONT'D)

Ice creeeeam!

JESSICA

Can we get one? I'm starving!

TOM

We just had lunch.

JESSICA
I'm starving to death!

BRY
Usual orders?

Soren and Jessica nod, pleased. Leaving the kids with Tom, Bry hauls herself off to the van.

12

EXT. ICE CREAM VAN - DAY

12

Standing in line, Bry checks her phone. A message from Inti - "Shona's been signed by Cage Combat!?" followed by a video link. She clicks.

An interview with Shona Robertson, (27, hard Glaswegian) speaking to a male INTERVIEWER off-camera.

SHONA
I'm Shona Robertson, and I'm about to become the first ever Cage Combat women's flyweight champion.

INTERVIEWER (O.S.)
You sound pretty confident the title's yours for the taking?

SHONA
No doubt. I know they're struggling to find a contender to match me, 'cause it's obvious there's ney a woman in my division that even comes close to my level...

Sound falls away. Bry looks up at her reflection in the ice cream van window. A shadow creeps across her face - the bright sunlight dulls down as if rain clouds have gathered overhead.

Dark clouds form around her. A deep, distant rumble of thunder. A few drops of rain land on the windowpane.

INTERVIEWER
(to camera)
Is anyone willing to step up to Shona and fight for the title?

A crack of overhead thunder and lightning is halted by -

ICE CREAM VAN MAN
What about you, love?

Bry looks up. We are wrenched back to reality - the sky is now bright and blazing sunshine glares off every surface. Heat shimmers in the air.

From Bry's perspective - kids are screaming, traffic blares, the mangled sound of the ice cream van is uncomfortably loud and strangely disconcerting.

13

EXT. BEACH HUT - DAY

13

Suddenly Bry sitting on a deckchair outside a beach hut with her family. They have all made a good dent in their ice creams. She shudders slightly as she notices her own ice cream has melted over her fist, untouched.

Soren's ice cream is smeared over his nose and chin - it's messy and disgusting. Tom wipes his face with a napkin.

SOREN

Get off!

JESSICA

How can you eat mint ice cream? So nasty.

SOREN

Toothpaste flavour!

TOM

He'll have fresh breath-

JESSICA

For once.

SOREN

Shut up.

Bry stares at the disintegrating cone in her hand. The drips have a waxy quality to them, as if the ice cream was a melting candle rather than something edible.

Bry deliberately drops the ice cream onto the pebbles and the ambient sound comes flooding back.

BRY

Oops.

JESSICA

Nooo! Do you want some of mine?

BRY

I could never deprive a starving child.

JESSICA

Good, I hate sharing.

Jessica has a big lick of her ice cream, making Bry chuckle. Then gives her mum a huge hug.

14

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

14

Later that night. Tom and Bry sit side by side on the couch, watching a movie. Tom's clearly made an effort with candles, popcorn - he's tried to make it special.

Except Bry isn't watching. She's engrossed in a brutal cage fight on her phone, where Shona Robertson batters another woman into submission. The graphic scenes are shown in pixellated close up.

Tom looks over, seeing Bry isn't watching the film. He takes a sneaky look at her screen.

TOM

How's Shona doing?

Bry jumps, quickly locks her phone as if she was just caught watching porn. Tom laughs.

TOM (CONT'D)

It's so nice spending quality time together.

BRY

(laughing along with him)
Oh God! Sorry.

TOM

At least its not Tinder! I know it's going to be tough giving up fighting. I appreciate it.

Bry nods. Chucks her phone.

BRY

I appreciate you.

She climbs on top of him, kisses him, gives him all of her attention.

BRY (CONT'D)

I'm so fucking lucky to have you.

She kisses him again, the heat rising. Tom smiles.

TOM

Correct.

He kisses her back, pulls her into him.

BRY

But you're a little bit more lucky-

TOM

Shut up.

They sink into the couch.

15 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - LATER 15

Bry has collapsed on Tom's chest, a throw covering their modesty. Tom is still slightly breathless after their exertions. He strokes her hair, kisses the top of her head.

TOM

I love you.

Silence. Confused, he shifts slightly to look at Bry's face. She's already fallen fast asleep. Tom gives a little laugh - this is typical. He wraps his arms around her anyway, grateful to have this rare moment of stillness together.

16 EXT. SOUTHAMPTON GENERAL HOSPITAL - DAY 16

Bry sits on a bench outside the hospital. She plops two caffeine pills into a takeaway coffee and swills the murky muck to dissolve, before going back to staring at her phone.

She has the number of a Cage Combat promoter up on her screen. Her knee jogs nervously, trying to muster the courage to dial.

Mark (the flirtatious doctor from the pub) pulls up and gets out of his suped up Audi. He clocks Bry's pills and coffee.

MARK

I'm referring you to cardiology.

BRY

Not if I refer you first.

She chucks him the pills, smiling.

MARK

So when are we all going out again?

But Bry's already dialled, and started walking away from him for some privacy. Mark shrugs, then chugs a couple of pills, washing them down with Red Bull.

17

INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - DAY

17

*

Bry trains with her coach, GREG SHANKLAND, (early 40s) in an MMA-focussed gym. Photos of Greg from his younger fighting days hang on the walls. Inti trains at another station.

*

He remorselessly pushes Bry close to breaking point. We hold on Bry as she repeats the same combo again and again and again, being hit in the face with the pads whenever she lets her guard down.

Eventually, Greg hits her so hard that her nose explodes blood. She drops to the mat and catches her breath.

GREG

Is your nose broken?

She shakes her head. He leans down and snarls in her ear.

GREG (CONT'D)

Then why are you still on the floor?

As soon as she stands, he unleashes a barrage of blows. Another coach, JAMIE (30s, much bigger) pulls Greg off her.

JAMIE

Fuck sake Greg, d'you want to condition her or kill her?

Bry, doubled over, holds up a bloodied hand to signal she's okay.

GREG

She's fine.

BRY

I'm fine.

Jamie is furious.

JAMIE

You of all people should be careful landing headshots.

GREG

Don't be jealous because she's hard
enough to train with me, unlike you
were, ya wee fanny. You're softer
than a dog's shite in the rain.

*
*

Jamie rolls his eyes, walks off. Under his breath-

JAMIE

Yeah, well, I didn't want to end up
like you, retired at 26 with
guacamole brain.

Greg picks up a pad and hurls it at Jamie, hitting in the
back.

*
*

GREG

You got something to say to me,
pal?

*
*

Jamie is furious, but bites his tongue. Despite being bigger
than Greg, he doesn't want to take him on. Other gym-users
exchange glances.

Bry eyes them, secretly proud that she can handle being
trained by the resident Begbie.

18 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM, STAIRWELL - EVENING

18 *

Bry is blissed out. This post-training or post-fight moment
is the only place she can be truly calm.

Greg hands Bry an ice pack for her nose. She gives him a
smile. A moment of uncertainty. Then he gives the smallest
nod of approval. She basks in its cool rays.

19 INT. BRY'S CAR - GOLDEN HOUR

19 *

Bry drives Greg home - apparently something they do
regularly. The car pulls up outside a rough estate.

GREG

Cheers.

He opens the passenger door to leave.

BRY

Wait-

Greg stops.

GREG

What?

BRY

I've put myself in the running for
Flyweight Champion of the World.

Bry expects Greg to be happy, but his face clouds with
disapproval.

GREG

What the fuck?

BRY

Do you want to train me?

GREG

Are you...**a dafty**? It's four fucking
weeks away!

*

BRY

Will you train me or-

He gets out and slams the door. Bry looks stressed.

Then Greg opens the door and sticks his head in.

GREG

Shona's going to hate you.

He slams the door. Bry looks more stressed. Greg opens it
again.

GREG (CONT'D)

Don't embarrass me.

He slams the door again. Bry smiles. She puts the car in gear
and drives off.

20

INT/**EXT.** STUDIO - DAY

20

*

Shona, standing against a graffiti-covered wall, sends Bry a
message.

SHONA

I know we were pals before this
fight, but all bets are off. You
asked for it so you're fucking
getting it.

We jump in to see pixilated close ups of Shona's eyes, mouth,
hands as she spits the following-

SHONA (CONT'D)

You don't have the guts or the skill to win against me, and deep down you've already lost. Cause I know you, Bryony. You were the good little girl at a nice suburban school. You don't know what it means to struggle. You've never really had to fight. You're nothing but an amateur taking on real professionals and it's just embarrassing. Listen, you already have a job, cleaning up the shit, piss and vomit of the sick and old. Stick to what you're good at in your mediocre little world, because my only job is to end careers and I'm about to end yours.

Over this, a polite voicemail bleeds in, drowning out Shona's snarling monologue. Bry strikes a casual, friendly, conciliatory tone.

BRY

Hey, it's Bry. I saw your Insta story and just wanted to make sure you're okay?

21

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT

21

Bry sits on the bed, staring out of the window. We move into close up on Bry's mouth as she leaves the voicemail, but it sounds tinny and crackly, as if it's coming through the phone.

BRY (ON PHONE)

Look. It's not personal. I just want a crack at the title. I'm looking forward to the fight. It'll be fun.

Beneath these pleasantries, we hear her inner thoughts in voiceover, increasingly in volume until they almost drown out her voice -

BRY (V.O.)

Fuck you, fuck you, fuck you, fuck you, fuck you..."

We pull back to show that behind the jovial tone, Bry looks stressed as she leaves the voicemail. Her knee jogs and although her mouth is smiling, her eyes tell a different story.

AUTOMATED VOICE (O.S.)
To delete message, press 1. To
leave your message, just hang up.

She presses 1.

AUTOMATED VOICE (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Message deleted.

TOM (O.S.)
Who was that?

Bry jumps - Tom has been standing in the doorway, who knows
for how long.

BRY
I... I've taken on one more fight.

Tom is annoyed, but keeps the smile on his face.

TOM
Right... and were you planning to
train for it in your lunch breaks?
And then sneak the fight in whilst
I was on a conference call?

BRY
Obviously I was going to tell you.
Just, you know, waiting for the
right time.

TOM
Yeah. So to be clear, it's always
the right time to talk to me.
Ideally *before* you make a decision
that affects the whole family...

BRY
I know. Sorry. That was shitty of
me.

Tom sits next to her. Smiles ruefully.

TOM
It'd better be a big one.

BRY
It is. It's going to make history.

Tom pulls her close. She nuzzles into him, grateful that he
understands her.

22 INT. HOSPITAL, ICU ROOM - NIGHT

22 *

Inti enters the ICU room, where she finds Mark and Bry in the *
midst of an argument by a FEMALE ICU PATIENT's bedside.

MARK

(curt)

Just do as I've asked.

BRY

Mark, it's an obvious cardiac
tamponade.

Inti stops in the doorway to listen.

MARK

We don't know that, and we need to
treat the blood pressure drop now,
before-

BRY

She'll go into arrest-

Inti deftly snags MISS NAIR, (50s) a senior consultant, as
she sails by.

INTI

Do you have a moment?

BRY

-we should take her for an echo-

Bry and Mark, caught mid-fight, reign it in as the more
senior doctor enters the room. Nair surveys the patient's
notes briefly whilst Mark holds forth. Touches the patient's
jugular.

MARK

Blood pressure drop post-
transplant. I was just about to
bring up her inotropes and-

MISS NAIR

Shh.

She takes her stethoscope and listens to the patient's
heartbeat.

MISS NAIR (CONT'D)

Beck's triad. It's an obvious
tamponade. Get an echo done and get
her to theatre, now.

Mark, chastened, gives Bry an embarrassed side glance. Instead of "I told you so", Bry just gives him a supportive smile. Mark is stoney-faced.

BRY
I'll give you a hand.

MARK
(snippy)
It's fine.

He kicks up the bed's brake and wheels the patient out. Nair follows, berating Mark.

MISS NAIR
Increasing her inotropes could've
killed her...

INTI
(sotto to Bry)
You have the patience of a saint
doing a 10,000 piece jigsaw puzzle
of a plate of spaghetti.

BRY
He's not that bad.

INTI
Point proven.

Inti and Bry reset the room in comfortable silence, something they will have done a thousand times before. Their movements are fluid, almost unconscious. Finally-

INTI (CONT'D)
Did you book the fight with Shona?

BRY
Yep.

INTI
Bet Tom was thrilled.

BRY
Nope.

INTI
She's tough, Bry. And when I say
tough, I mean a total psycho.

BRY
(smiling)
It'll be fun.

INTI
 (smiling back)
 Just try not to die. You have a
 family, remember?

BRY
 Yes, but only because you keep
 reminding me.

Inti smirks, despite her worry.

23 INT. STUDENT FLAT, TOILET - DAY [FLASHBACK] 23

12 years earlier.

Young Bry (28) is sitting on the toilet staring in shock at
 the positive pregnancy test in her hands.

YOUNG BRY
 Fuck.

24 INT. STUDENT FLAT, KITCHEN - DAY [FLASHBACK] 24

Young Bry and Young Inti sit together at the kitchen table. A
 long silence.

YOUNG INTI
 Are you going to keep it?

A pause as Bry thinks about it. But there's no other option.

YOUNG BRY
 (softly)
 I have to.

YOUNG INTI
 Fuck sake. You're a pro-choice
 medical professional with free
 nationalised healthcare, you know
 you don't have to.

YOUNG BRY
 I do.

YOUNG INTI
 Why?

Bry looks away.

YOUNG BRY
 I don't know.

YOUNG INTI
Then don't do it.

YOUNG BRY
I just know they'll be the love of
my life. I'm going to give them
everything I never had.

YOUNG INTI
Bry... You're not well enough...
You're not ready.

This is a real concern for Bry. She covers.

YOUNG BRY
Who is?

Inti hugs her. Over Bry's shoulder-

YOUNG INTI
True.

Over Inti's shoulder, Bry holds back tears.

A pause as they take in the enormity of the situation. Inti
breaks the mood.

YOUNG INTI (CONT'D)
So. Do you know who the father is?

Bry finally cracks a smile.

YOUNG BRY
Fuck you. Of course I do... I
think.

Inti cackles.

YOUNG INTI
So go on then, who is he?

YOUNG BRY
Just some kid I met at the gym.
Christ. I hope he's legal. I think
he still had backnee. Hang on.

She takes her phone out and looks him up - "Tom PBC". Inti
leans in to look.

YOUNG INTI
What does "PBC" stand for?

Bry dials.

YOUNG BRY
Potential Booty Call.
(off Inti's look)
What? I'm an organised person. It's
quicker to label than to scroll.

Inti chuckles, shaking her head.

YOUNG INTI
God help this child.

25 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - DAY

25

Bry's face dips in and out of shot as she does press ups.
Greg paces, barking his philosophy down at her.

GREG
You need to be focussed on this
fight, every second of every day.

We track over Greg's taught traps, his battered knuckles,
cauliflower ears. The track mark scars on his delts and
quads, some fresh marks swollen from infection.

GREG (CONT'D)
I put everything I had into this
sport - no wife, no kids, no
friends, no fucking hobbies, no
distractions - and I still didn't
make it. You have to live and
breathe it. Obsession isn't a flaw...
it's the price of entry. Champions
aren't balanced. They're built from
pain, not comfort. So if you're
here to be good, to be liked, to be
safe... leave now... But if you're here
to be remembered, then fight like
it's the only thing keeping you
from fading away. Get in that ring
and **fucking kill her.**

*

26 EXT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARDEN - DAY

26

Bry, in her sports gear, has Jessica helping her train.
Jessica, despite her young age, makes an incredibly
convincing trainer - she calls combos like a pro and Bry
doesn't hold back.

JESSICA
1, 2, slip, 4. 1, 2, slip, 4. 1, 2,
Cover, 2. 1, 2, Cover, 2.
(MORE)

JESSICA (CONT'D)

1, 2, Slip, 6, 3. 1, 2, 3, Cover,
3. 1, 2, 3, Cover, 3...

Music builds...

27 INT/EXT. VARIOUS [TRAINING MONTAGE]

27

In a music-driven high paced montage, Bry trains with ever greater intensity.

- Bry boxes a punchbag at the gym.
- She runs along the sea front, lapping the other runners. Sits on the Titanic memorial to catch her breath.
- She takes Jessica to a class at the gym in her uniform.
- Greg has Bry balancing on thick pipe segments whilst lifting weights.
- Bry bobs and weaves ducking under a rope.
- She punches a much larger FEMALE FIGHTER at the gym. The spectators wince.
- She gets punched by Soren whilst play-fighting at home and throws herself across the room, making him laugh.
- She grabs some sneaky tricep dips in a stairwell in her nurse's uniform. Mark catches her and smiles.
- Bry is in a stress-position, holding weights. Greg gets in her ear, telling her to give up.
- She and Greg grapple on the floor. She is slammed into the mat again and again, but despite being smaller than him, she finally manages to pin him down. Greg is grudgingly impressed.

28 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT [MONTAGE]

28

Bry watches a montage of interviews with Shona. First, we see her being interviewed at the gym, people boxing in the background. We cut between pixellated close ups of each scene - Shona's eyes, hands, mouth.

SHONA

-I don't want kids. Never.
Fighting's everything to me-

Next she's in a greasy spoon, talking to a mate. The interview is filmed on a mobile phone.

SHONA (CONT'D)

-My focus never leaves the cage-

Now we see Shona standing against a mural on a street corner waving a pink fly swatter around.

SHONA (CONT'D)

I'm going to make history when I
become the first female Cage Combat
Flyweight World Champion, after I
swat the so-called Killa Bee.

The image freezes.

Bry stares obsessively at Shona's image in freeze-frame.

Her concentration is broken by Soren's high pitched scream. She looks over to Tom, who snores loudly. Waits to see if Soren will stop.

He doesn't. Eventually Bry hauls herself out of bed.

29

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE - VARIOUS [MONTAGE]

29

Bry spends less time with family. From Tom's perspective, we see her increasing absence.

- Bry passes Soren's bedroom door whilst Tom gets Soren dressed.

- Bry scrolls through long training analysis texts from Greg at the dinner table. Jessica snatches her phone, laughing.

- Bry passes the living room window on the way to her car whilst Tom builds a complicated Lego structure with the kids.

- Bry sneaks in late at night, passing the door to the living room where Tom has fallen asleep on the couch. She puts a blanket over him gently.

- Bry's seat at the dinner table remains unoccupied as the rest of the family eat. Jessica stares at the empty seat, her dinner untouched.

- Tom hands Bry a packed lunch as she rushes out the door. She kisses him and runs out.

He is left in the kitchen, staring after her. The front door slams and the sound echoes round the empty house.

30 INT. BRY'S CAR - DAY [MONTAGE] 30

Bry chucks the packed lunch into the footwell under the passenger seat of her car, where it joins a pile of discarded lunches.

31 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - VARIOUS [MONTAGE] 31

Greg ramps up the punishing training regime. Bry endures horrible training methods, brutal and cruel.

- Bry is punched in the stomach over and over again to train her core.

- Bry runs until she throws up.

- Bry takes on a MALE FIGHTER twice her size... and loses.

- Bry is slammed against the cage and canvas again and again. Blood pours from cuts to her eyebrows, nose and lips.

Over this we hear Shona trash talking her.

SHONA (V.O)

Bryony Tyrell is fucking pathetic.
I've trained with her, and I can
tell you now, she doesn'y have what
it takes. She has about as much
killer instinct as you'd expect a
middle aged, middle class, middle
of the road nurse to have...

Strangely, Shona's voice morphs into Bry's.

BRY (V.O.)

...She's bitten off more than she
can chew by taking me on. I'm gonna
make sure this is her last fight.

- Bry holds her head back to stem the bleeding from her nose. Her eyes stream involuntarily.

- Early morning. Bry in her nurse's uniform covered with a long coat, face bruised, tries to start her car for the twentieth time. Hammers on the steering wheel and screams in frustration. Tears pour down her face.

END OF MONTAGE.

32 INT. TOM'S CAR - MORNING LATER 32

Tom drives Bry to work in silence. Tries to find the words.

TOM

Do you think you might be pushing yourself a little too hard?

BRY

I can't just run away because it's hard, Tom.

Her tone is designed to shut him down. But Tom persists, using humour to avoid escalation.

TOM

You don't need to add any more cardio to your routine. Walk away. Slowly. To the couch. Watch a Disney movie at 10am with an Egg McMuffin and the kids all curled up around you. They'd love that. I'd love that. Wouldn't you love that?

Bry half-smiles, but says nothing. They pull up outside the hospital. Tom grabs her wrist before she can leave. Pulls her in for a kiss.

TOM (CONT'D)

I love you.

BRY

Love you too.

Bry gets out, watches Tom drive off.

33

INT. TOM'S CAR - VARIOUS [MONTAGE]

33

Tom drives home. Picks up the kids. Drops them at school. Runs errands. Drives to work. Picks the kids up. Takes them to various after school clubs. We jump-cut through this as if Tom's whole day is spent playing taxi-driver.

On the drive, Soren is in the back, wearing headphones, whilst Jessica sits in the front, in her Taekwondo dobok. Something is on her mind. She finally musters the courage to speak.

JESSICA

Dad. I don't want to go to Taekwondo.

TOM

Oh. Are you okay?

JESSICA

Yeah. I just don't want to go anymore. There's an art club Alex goes to at the same time, I'd rather do that.

TOM

Well, of course, you should do whatever you want to do.

JESSICA

Don't tell Mum.

TOM

I won't. You should tell her yourself. She'll understand.

JESSICA

(unsure)

Yeah.

TOM

Just... wait til after her fight.

JESSICA

(a hint of bitterness)

Yeah. Right.

34

INT. HOSPITAL, STAIRWELL - DUSK

34

*

Bry calls Tom at the end of a long shift.

BRY

(into phone)

Hi, I'm finished. Can you pick me up?

TOM (O.S.)

(on phone)

Am I bringing you home?

BRY

I can't, Tom. I have to train.

TOM (O.S.)

Do you?

BRY

It'll only be an hour.

*

35 INT. TOM'S CAR - NIGHT

35

Tom drives along in silence, Bry in the passenger seat, Soren and Jessica in the back.

BRY
Next left here, I need to make a quick stop.

TOM
What for?

BRY
Just need to drop some meds to a patient.

TOM
(irritated)
Bry, that's not your job.

BRY
Well, she's housebound and doesn't have family in the UK. One tiny detour, one tiny gym session, max an hour, then home. Don't hate me.

*
*

Tom shakes his head, this might be the straw that broke the camel's back.

BRY (CONT'D)
Please? I'll make break-feast tomorrow.

Tom cracks a very small smile. Gives her a side glance. Then nods.

TOM
Deal.

The kids exchange glances, pleased with the outcome of this near-argument.

36 INT. T.K.O MMA GYM - NIGHT

36

Bry gets slammed into the mat. Greg pins her. She eventually struggles free.

GREG
You fucking waste of space.

Bry hits him, it barely connects.

GREG (CONT'D)
You're past it.

She tries to take Greg down. Fails.

GREG (CONT'D)
Focus!

He hits her.

37 INT. TOM'S CAR - NIGHT

37

Tom waits outside the gym in the car, but Bry's late - his phone shows it's almost 11pm. The kids sleep in the back - out way past their bedtime.

Tom tries to call Bry. His call list tells us he's been trying for some time, but it goes straight to voicemail.

BRY (O.S.)
(voicemail)
Hi, this is Bryony Tyrell, please
leave me a message-

He hangs up, pissed off. Gets out of the car, closing the door gently so as not to wake the kids, and locks them in. Not happy about leaving them alone, he walks at pace towards the gym.

38 INT. T.K.O MMA GYM - NIGHT

38

Tom blinks in the bright strip lighting of the gym foyer. At the far end of a corridor, he can hear Bry cry out in pain.

Shaken, he creeps down the corridor to the gym, where he sees Bry fighting with Greg. They grapple on the mat. Greg, heavier and stronger, easily dominates, crushing Bry's tiny frame into the ground.

Tom watches through the window in the door, anger rising. Greg punches Bry in the head. Tom snaps. Throws open the door, shouting-

TOM
Get the fuck off her. Now.

Greg looks up, bemused.

GREG
Who are you?

TOM
Bry, it's 11pm. We're going home.

BRY
Tom, I-

GREG
We're not finished.

TOM
(to Greg)
Take a look at yourself. You're definitely finished. And if my wife ever comes home from training with a black eye again, you'll be dealing with me.
(he jabs his finger into his temple)
Fucked up piece of shit.

Greg chuckles with disbelief as Bry gathers her things.

BRY
Sorry, Greg.

TOM
Don't apologise for me.

Tom eyeballs Greg, then stalks out, Bry following behind with an apologetic backwards glance.

Greg is left alone. A smirk on his face, which slowly fades.

39 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT

39

Bry emerges from the ensuite in an ugly old robe. Tom suddenly grabs her, pushes her against the wall, kisses her, throws her onto the bed and tries to have more dominant sex with her.

After a slight struggle, she pushes him away.

BRY
This isn't what I want from you.

It's said with kindness, but still cuts him deep. She kisses him. He kisses her back and then retreats.

They lie side by side, panting yet unsatisfied.

40 INT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

40

12 years earlier.

Young Bry stretches before a jujitsu class. She's the first there, and stretches out on her back, alone, peaceful. The sound of her breath is replaced by the sound of gently crashing waves.

As the rest of the class drift in gradually, she notices a new student, Young Tom, walk into the room. He's cute, in a geeky way. He clocks her looking. Smiles and looks away. There's a hint of shyness in Tom's smile that fires something in Bry.

41 INT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

41

Later, Young Bry has made sure she's partnered up with Young Tom despite the ridiculous height and weight difference. They spar.

YOUNG BRY
(flirting)
What have you got for me?

Across the room, Greg observes their body language, glowering.

YOUNG BRY (CONT'D)
Don't hold back. I have a blackbelt in kickboxing and kung fu. No offence, but you're not going to hurt me.

She throws a couple of gentle kicks to get things going.

Greg stomps over, furious. Shoves her out of the way so he can spar with Tom. Hits him, hard. Tom reels from the blow and Bry jumps to his defence.

YOUNG BRY (CONT'D)
Hey!

YOUNG GREG
Fuck off. You're fighting like a 6 year old girl. Go and find someone else to spar with.

*

YOUNG BRY
No!

YOUNG GREG
Then fucking hit him.

YOUNG BRY

Fine!

Pissed off, Bry kicks Tom across the room. She's immediately flooded with guilt, and rushes over to help him. Greg smirks.

YOUNG BRY (CONT'D)

I'm so sorry, I thought you were ready-

She hauls him up.

YOUNG TOM

Don't be sorry. A lot of men would pay good money to be beaten by a beautiful woman.

YOUNG BRY

That your thing, is it?

YOUNG TOM

Maybe you'll find out...
(clutching his ribs)
...if you don't hospitalise me first.

Bry laughs, charmed. Greg glowers: that backfired.

42

EXT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

42

After class, Young Bry catches Young Tom as he's unlocking his bike. It's a real piece of shit - horrible colour, ugly design and rusted to high heaven.

YOUNG BRY

Sweet ride. Shame it doesn't have pegs - I'd love to be seen cruising around town on the back of that chopper.

YOUNG TOM

You can have the seat, I'll stand and pedal.

YOUNG BRY

Hmmm... I'll pass.

YOUNG TOM

Hey, I know it doesn't look like much, but this is the perfect bike for me. I can leave it chained up outside the pub all weekend and it'll still be there on Monday.

(MORE)

YOUNG TOM (CONT'D)

You'd have to be really, really
desperate to steal this bike.

YOUNG BRY

Surely it must have other good
qualities?

YOUNG TOM

Oh, it does, it does. It rides like
a piece of shit too. So even if it
does get stolen, they won't get
very far.

Bry smiles.

YOUNG BRY

You can leave it here then.

43 INT. SMALL TOWN CLUB, TABLE - NIGHT [FLASHBACK] 43

Young Bry and Young Tom lift full pint glasses, then slam
empty pint glasses down on the table in unison. Bang, bang,
bang. Again with shot glasses. Bang, bang, bang.

44 OMITTED 44

45 INT. SMALL TOWN CLUB, DANCE FLOOR - NIGHT [FLASHBACK] 45

Young Bry and Young Tom dance together. They pop pills in
unison. The music pounds: Bang, bang, bang.

45A INT. SMALL TOWN CLUB, STAIRCASE - NIGHT [FLASHBACK] 45A *

Young Bry drags Young Tom down the stairs. *

46 INT. SMALL TOWN CLUB, TOILETS - NIGHT [FLASHBACK] 46

The music continues as Young Bry and Young Tom sneak into a
stall. Bry kicks down the toilet lid. Bry watches Tom as he
racks up cocaine, smiling at his unpracticed hand. She places
her hand over his, and guides the credit card until they have
two neat lines.

Tom hands her a rolled up note.

YOUNG BRY

Chivalry is not dead.

She snorts her line and hands him the note.

YOUNG TOM
I like how low you're setting that
bar.

YOUNG BRY
It pays to have low expectations of
everyone but yourself.

YOUNG TOM
I can see that.

Bry looks at Tom, curiously. We think she is about to jump
him when-

BANG BANG BANG! A BOUNCER hammers on the cubical door.

BOUNCER
Right kids. Off you fuck.

Caught, Tom and Bry snigger like teenagers and slope out.

47 EXT. SOUTHAMPTON STREET - NIGHT [FLASHBACK] 47 *

Young Tom and Young Bry are ejected from the club. *

BOUNCER *
You're barred! *

Tom takes Bry (and himself) by surprise and slams her up
against a fence, kissing her passionately. They tear into one
another. *

48 INT. YOUNG TOM'S STUDENT DIGS - MORNING [FLASHBACK] 48

The next morning, Young Tom wakes up to find Young Bry
dressed and halfway out the door. She shoots him a sweet,
genuine smile, and then she's gone.

49 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT [PRESENT] 49

Back to the present, in the marital bedroom.

TOM
Do you like it when Greg hurts you?
Is this some weird sex thing?

BRY
(mortified)
God, no.

TOM

Get another trainer then. It's common knowledge that he's not right in the head.

BRY

And I am?

TOM

Bry, this is just another way of you harming yourself.

BRY

No, Tom, it's conditioning-

TOM

Let me ask you something. If you saw a child going through what you went through, at the same age, would you blame them for what was happening?

BRY

Of course not.

TOM

So if you're not to blame, if that *little girl* is not to blame, why do you keep punishing her?

This hits Bry hard. She searches for the right words.

BRY

Just come to the fight. You'll understand if you see me fight.

TOM

No. I'm not going to watch you... I don't want to see that.

BRY

Please. I need you there.

Tom looks her in the eyes.

TOM

What about what I need?

BRY

Okay, tell me.

TOM

I need this to be your last fight.

BRY

Don't... I thought you supported my career.

TOM

This isn't your career. You're a nurse, and you're good at it. MMA is a hobby that could see you hospitalised, or brain damaged... or killed.

BRY

Please don't ask me to-

TOM

I'll keep asking you to stop. And then one day I won't. Because if you keep making me feel invisible, eventually I'll disappear.

BRY

(defensive)

Is that a threat?

TOM

I just need you to put us first.

Bry examines his face, trying to work out if he really means it.

BRY

Okay. I promise.

She's genuine. Tom's hard edge fades. He looks like he might cry with relief.

TOM

Thank you.

Bry can't stand to see him hurting. She pulls him into her, holding him as if a storm was raging around them. A wind whips up and blows their hair, whistling through the house.

MATCH CUT TO:

50

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - DAY

50

Gentle birdsong. Tom wakes up in bed alone.

51 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, KITCHEN - DAY

51

Tom walks into the kitchen to find Jessica and Soren, already washed and dressed for school, grazing from a huge assortment of breakfast items, artfully arranged on the dining table - eggs three ways, sausages, bacon, beans, toast, pancakes, croissants, berries, bananas, yoghurts and cereals. There is one empty place setting for Tom.

JESSICA

Mum cancelled your alarm, said you deserved a lie in.

TOM

She's already gone?

JESSICA

Yeah, she's on the early shift before the drive up to Scotland.

Soren gestures to Tom's chair.

SOREN

Break-feast?

Tom sits down. A small smile. Jess is on her phone, scrolling through a list of 'Androgenous baby names'.

TOM

Hey! No phones at the feast.

Jess jumps. Locks her phone, smiling with a hint of embarrassment.

52 INT. BRY'S CAR - EVENING

52

A hot summer's evening. Bry and Greg drive up to Glasgow. They barely speak. Greg is pensive, worried about the fight. He taps his fingers nervously on the door handle. Bry picks up on this.

BRY

I never knew how much you cared.

GREG

Fuck off.

BRY

You going to see your mum whilst
you're up?

GREG

Fuck off.

*
*
*

*
*

53 INT. GLASGOW ARENA, CHANGING ROOM - DAY

53 *

Bry, wrapped in clingfilm, does push ups until she's ragged. She takes a tiny sip of water before Greg snatches the bottle out of her hand.

GREG

Up.

She drags herself off the floor to start hitting the pads.

GREG (CONT'D)

Come on, come on, come on-

Bry punches faster and faster until she collapses in a dead faint. Greg looks down at her, face unreadable. Then gently picks her up and carries her to a physio bench. He stares at her thoughtfully, then taps her on the cheek.

GREG (CONT'D)

Bry. Wake up. You've got to get to the weigh in.

54 OMITTED

54

55 INT. GLASGOW ARENA, CORRIDOR - DAY

55 *

Bry walks up a dark corridor. The sound of an ANNOUNCER introducing fighters over a PA wafts in from the studio.

Shona strides up the corridor, past Bry.

BRY

Shona?

Shona stops and turns to Bry.

SHONA

Alright, Bry.

BRY

What's going on?

Shona smiles in a friendly, bemused fashion. Her accent is thick Glaswegian, but her tone is far gentler than we have heard up until now.

SHONA

How'd you mean, pal?

Bry loses her footing, disarmed by Shona's lack of aggression. With less conviction -

BRY

Why are you constantly attacking me?

Shona laughs, as though confused.

SHONA

We're fighters, Bry. It's sort of what we do.

BRY

No, you're getting personal-

SHONA

Hey, look, we're fighters, but we're also performers. Got to give the cameras something, you know?

Bry shakes her head.

BRY

It's more than that. The YouTube onslaughts-

Shona is getting irritated, but keeps her cool.

SHONA

Onslaughts? Listen to me, Bry. I devoted my whole life to this sport. I fucking love it. You don't look like you're still loving it. So what're you doing here?

56 INT. STUDENT FLAT, KITCHEN - DAY [FLASHBACK]

56

12 years earlier. Young Inti on her mobile, speaking quietly.

YOUNG INTI

She's like she was when she tried to end it... I know, but I can't get her out of bed. She's not showered in days...

57 INT. STUDENT FLAT, BRY'S ROOM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

57

The door to Bry's room flies open and Young Inti marches in.

Young Bry barely moves, pulling the covers up a little higher.

Inti throws her gym bag on the bed.

YOUNG INTI
Do you want to feel something?

Bry finally looks up, curiosity piqued.

58 EXT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

58

Young Inti and Young Bry approach the gym. It's on a run-down industrial estate and looks rough.

YOUNG BRY
Where the fuck have you brought me?
I'm not into this.

YOUNG INTI
You're acting like you have
something to lose.

YOUNG BRY
I'm going home.

She starts to walk away. Inte grabs her.

YOUNG INTI
No. Either you have something to
lose, so you can snap the fuck out
of this and do something with it,
or you have nothing to lose, so it
doesn't matter what happens to you
when you go through that door.
Which is it?

Bry looks miserable.

59 INT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - DAY [FLASHBACK]

59

Young Inti introduces Young Bry to YOUNG GREG. In Inti's borrowed gym gear we can see how emaciated she is - she looks like she would snap like a twig in a moderate breeze.

YOUNG INTI
Greg. This is Bry. She'll be shit
so go easy on her.

YOUNG GREG
Nope. At the front, please.

60 INT. MARTIAL ARTS GYM - LATER [FLASHBACK] 60

Young Greg leads the class. Young Bry stands out immediately - she's clearly had some training, but it's more than that - she throws herself into the class with a fearless intensity unmatched by any of the other students. The need in her eyes is real, and Greg sees it.

61 INT. GLASGOW ARENA, CORRIDOR - DAY [PRESENT] 61 *

Snap back to the present. Shona looks at Bry with pity.

SHONA

Bry. You've got a nice life. Why isn't that enough for you?

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)

...Moving onto the main card, at 9 o'clock, we kick off with women's flyweight-

SHONA

That's us!

Shona shoots Bry an excited grin before heading into the studio. Bry is left alone in the corridor, stunned, then follows slowly after.

62 INT. HOTEL RESTAURANT - NIGHT 62

Bry is alone in a hotel restaurant, loading calories in a compulsive, depressive way. The plate is piled with food. It all looks the same waxy shade of beige. Deeply unappetising.

Bry is watching the first YouTube video of Shona hurling abuse at her. But now we see the real video - Shona is more jovial, all the previous aggression and personal slights are dialled right back.

SHONA

I know we were pals before this fight, but all bets are off. You asked for it, so you're getting it.

But rather than launching into a stream of hyperbolic invective as we saw the first time, she takes a different tone entirely.

I've been training hard all my life and I can't wait to get in the cage.

(MORE)

SHONA (CONT'D)

It's time for Glasgow MMA to make history and for me to become the first ever female flyweight champion...

We see Shona's down to earth charm, and why she is so beloved by the MMA world.

Bry watches in horror. This is not the video she remembers. Is she losing her mind?

Greg appears and watches Bry. Finally, he sits with her. Bry looks up, shaken.

GREG

I want you to think about what happened to me. I lost concentration for a second in the cage, and I lost everything. But Bry, you can take the hits. You can give them back. You've worked so hard for this. You're ready.

Bry smiles, gratefully. She's been looking for this approval from Greg for so long.

But when she turns away, we can see that in her mind, she's already lost.

63

INT. GLASGOW ARENA, **FOYER** - NIGHT

63

*

The night of the title fight. The muffled sounds of the stadium bleed into the locker room.

Bry, hair braided and tied back, mentally prepares herself for the fight. She is anxious, moves very little, stretching gently, trying to centre herself.

As the Announcer introduces the bout, we close in on Bry's face.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)

Ladies and gentlemen, this is the main event of the evening. Please welcome these two athletes as they make their way into the cage tonight to battle for the vacant Cage Combat Women's Flyweight Championship.

64 INT. GLASGOW ARENA - NIGHT

64

Close on the ANNOUNCER.

ANNOUNCER

First up, fighting out of the blue corner, please put it together for Bryony Tyrell.

65 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

65

Tom watches the fight on his laptop. Fan on, windows open, it's a sweltering night. He bites the inside of his cheek, nervously.

On the screen: Bry emerges from the shadows and walks into the stadium. As her entry music starts up she just stands still, backed by her team, her mouthguard distorting her expressionless face as she stares out into the arena. The place is vast. Bry looks so small.

Tom blows out air, trying not to throw up with anxiety.

66 INT. GLASGOW ARENA - NIGHT

66

Close on Bry as she begins her walk to the cage. The atmosphere is toxic - the crowd showering her with disgusting slurs. Children boo her and give her the thumbs down. A BALDING MAN leans over the barriers to growl -

BALDING MAN

You're gonna get raped.

Bry meets her CUT MAN, who smears Vaseline on her eyebrows, nose and cheekbones. She smiles nervously as she steps into the ring and runs to her corner.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)

And fighting out of the red corner, let's hear it for Shona Robertson.

Shona bounces gleefully, wrapped in a Celtic F.C. flag. She bumps fists with crowd members as she makes her way to the cage with great fanfare and cheers of support. Smiling, confident, charismatic.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Coming live from the Glasgow Arena, and being watched around the world, this is Cage Combat 90!

The crowd goes wild. We see Bry, leaning from foot to foot, nodding awkwardly as if she wishes the camera wasn't on her.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.) (CONT'D)

A free-style fighter with a professional record of 4 wins, 1 loss, 1 draw, standing 5 feet 7 inches tall, she weighed in a shade over 123 pounds, fighting out of Southampton, England's Bryony "Killa Bee" Tyrell.

At her name, Bry throws her fists up, smiling wide. The yellow-green mouth shield makes her smile seem even stranger. The audience boos and she dies a little inside.

The Announcer moves onto Shona with an audible increase in volume and enthusiasm.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.) (CONT'D)

A striker and grappler, with a professional record of 6 wins and 1 loss, she stands at exactly the limit of 125 pounds. She proudly fights as Glasgow's own Shona Robertson!

Robertson struts around the ring, shadow boxing, leaning in to say a few inaudible words to the camera, throwing her arms up and hyping the stadium to cheer louder.

The REFEREE, after struggling to get Shona's attention, finally pulls the women into the centre of the ring.

REFEREE

Ladies, you understand the rules you're fighting under. Listen to me at all times, keep yourself protected. When I say stop, you stop. If you wanna touch gloves, do it now.

Shona and Bry face off. Shona says something to Bry that we don't hear. Whatever she says, it shakes Bry to the core. Prompted by the Referee, they touch gloves and back away.

The Referee chops the air for the fight to begin.

The fighters circle one another warily, trying to figure the other out. Robertson attacks first. The crowd noise feels distant as we watch the women spar.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.)

Robertson, centre of the cage,
slinging heavy leather at Bryony
Tyrell. She's getting in, she's
getting out. Not getting too
dragged down in this. Long way to
go in five fives.

Bry gets in a few solid hits, but they are not as heavy as
the swings Shona is throwing.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Tyrell taking her time. Doing a
good job of staying out of the way
here, good circling. She seems calm
in the face of an incredibly
partisan crowd. But you do feel
like Robertson is getting that
little bit closer every time.

When we come in close we see that Bry's face is fixed in a
rictus grin of anxiety. She is keeping light on her feet and
defending, but Shona is dominating and every blow she lands,
the crowd buoys her up for it. The sound from the crowd is
suddenly extremely loud.

CROWD MEMBER (O.S.)

Tyrell! Fucking die!

Shona starts playing to the audience, rolling her eyes at
Bry's attempted shots, "winding up" her left hook before
going in with the right, making a show of mocking her.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.)

Robertson throwing the left hand
here, she's got heat on both those
fists.

She connects with Bry's chin and the audience erupts. Close
on Bry, totally demoralised, yet still smiling. We stay very
close on her over the following, which may or may not be in
her head:

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

And really what was the point in
Tyrell taking on this match? She's
way past her best. The bookie's
odds say it all. She might as well
give up now.

Bry rallies. We come out wide again. She gets Shona into a
body-lock against the cage wall.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Here we go, this is the first tie up that these ladies have had in any kind of grappling exchange. It's a good body-lock for Tyrell here. Bringing some knees in, good wrist grab, very very strong clinch position for her. Question is, how strong is Robertson?

Shona breaks out of the hold.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

And there it is, easy break to separate the distance. And Shona comes back strong.

Shona fights back with a flurry of blows. Bry backs off.

We see Bry's POV - Shona close and personal.

SHONA

You're an embarrassment-

COMMENTATOR

Robertson is talking to Tyrell, trying to play some mind games. I've seen Shona put an opponent flat on their back with one punch, so credit to the chin of Tyrell here. She's done a good job of weathering this storm and seeing out the first round.

The bell sounds. Bry touches gloves with Robertson and returns to her corner.

Greg and the other cornerman spray water in Bry's face and patch up any bleeding before the bell.

GREG

Keep the range, keep the distance. Attack her midsection, tire her out.

He leans in and pulls her forehead to his.

GREG (CONT'D)

(quietly)

I can see you're holding back. Don't. You can win this.

Bry nods, but quickly turns away.

Second round.

Bry and Shona spar with greater intensity.

COMMENTATOR

They're cheering for Robertson here, but Bryony's still got a big smile on her face. Anyone who enjoys violence this much is definitely a force to be reckoned with. Tyrell is an ICU nurse by day and she often says most of her colleagues can't believe she does this for fun on the weekends.

Shona smashes Bry in the face.

67 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 67

Tom flinches at the blow, hating every minute but unable to look away.

Jessica, in her pyjamas, watches through the banisters, unseen by her father. Concern etched onto her young brow.

68 INT. GLASGOW ARENA - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 68

Bry fights back. She grapples with Shona, knocking her off-balance and almost taking her down.

COMMENTATOR

Oh here we go! A strong hold from Tyrell.

Bry brings Shona to the mat, choking her. Shona's eyelids flutter.

COMMENTATOR (CONT'D)

This could be it for Robertson!

The Referee gets down to check on Shona and it looks like he may stop the fight. But Shona twists out of the hold.

COMMENTATOR (CONT'D)

Robertson breaks free. A close call there.

The fighters circle one another. Shona, pissed off by this near loss, stares daggers at Bry. Then she very deliberately stops, looks down at her glove and adjusts it slightly. Bry respectfully holds off.

Shona makes to glove tap, a signal to restart the fight. Bry drops her guard for a moment to engage in this gesture of sportsmanship.

A sudden flurry of blows has Bry pinned against the cage.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Ohhh. Robertson pouncing here. Big hooks! Tyrell covering up, trying to fight back -

We slow down and track into Bry's eyes as they struggle to stay locked with Shona's. But then, she becomes momentarily distracted by something off-screen. Pure terror. The Commentator's voice grows quiet, menacing.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Tyrell wasn't meant to win this fight. She will never win. Her life is nothing more than an endless river of losses.

In extreme slow motion, we see what she sees: Young Bry, wearing the same clothes as in the opening scene and soaking wet, standing stock still in the audience, watching ominously. The sounds of the ring fade away, replaced by the sound of a river. We track in on her mirror image, who speaks with the Commentator's voice.

COMMENTATOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)

She floats aimlessly into obscurity. No one will mourn her. No one will remember her.

Bry's face slackens into a mask of apathy. She goes limp. A shadow passes over her face as though clouds are gathering overhead. Thunder crashes and lightning flickers unnaturally.

REFEREE (O.S.)

Stop, stop-

The referee gets between them, waving his arms to signal stoppage. He sounds as if he's underwater.

The crowd roars and Shona celebrates, but Bry is a thousand miles away. The roar of the crowd becomes another clap of thunder. The sharp ring of the bell takes us to-

Bry sits in an armchair. She remains blank and static as we jump cut through the following scenes:

- The kids run through frame, in vests and shorts, shooting each other with Nerf guns.
- Tom vacuums under Bry.
- Harper puts a Halloween pumpkin in the window.
- Soren, in hat and gloves, is zipped into his winter coat.
- Tom brings Bry a cup of tea, sits next to her puts the TV on.
- Tom and the kids put the star on top of the Christmas tree.

SOREN

Mum! Come on.

He grabs her hand, tries to wrench her from the chair.

SOREN (CONT'D)

Fight me!

He pretends to pummel her but she just brushes him off. He climbs on her, trying to wrestle her out of the chair.

SOREN (CONT'D)

Are you just going to let me win?

He gives up, and his playful wrestle turns into a hug. Bry pats him dispassionately.

Eventually he just sits beside her, glumly staring at the TV, mimicking her posture. Finally, he wanders into the kitchen.

Reveal Bry's eldest, watching this sad scene unfold. They look different - they sport a more androgynous look. From this point, they are known as 'Harper'.

Harper stares at Bry. Their intense admiration has turned to disgust.

Bry stares at the TV. The weather is forecast to rain for weeks to come, the astons lamenting: "No chance of a White Christmas this year". Harper turns the TV off and leaves the room as if Bry wasn't even there. Bry doesn't move.

In the black reflection of the screen, a grey cloud gathers around Bry's head until she is totally enveloped.

70 HOSPITAL, NURSE'S STATION - NIGHT 70 *

Bry sits at the nurses' station, decked out in Christmas decorations, listening to a voicemail message from Morrigan. *
* *

MORRIGAN REP

Hi there Bryony, this is Charlie
from Morrigan. We would like to
offer you a fight with Isa Janssen
at Wembley on the 22nd April. Would
you mind giving me a call back on-

Bry lowers the phone and stabs at the keypad. *

AUTOMATED VOICE

Message deleted. To listen to your
saved messages, press one...

Bry's dead-eyed stare. All the fight's gone out of her.

71 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, KITCHEN - DAY 71 *

Tom and Bry cook Christmas dinner. Tom is on a call with his
PARENTS (70s) on speakerphone as he preps vegetables.

TOM

Look, we're almost ready to eat so
I'd better go. Miss you both.

TOM'S MUM

(from phone)
Okay. Love you, darling.

TOM'S DAD

(from phone)
Merry Christmas, son. Love you.

TOM

Love you too.

The call ends.

TOM (CONT'D)

Are you going to call your parents?

BRY

Umm. Yeah. Maybe later.

Tom doesn't push it. Just nods.

72 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - DAY 72 *

Harper and Soren sit on the couch. Soren is watching a Christmas movie, whilst Harper scrolls aimlessly on an iPad, the box and wrapping paper on the cushion beside them.

On the iPad: Bry's social media. Photos of her in a past life - smiling, happy, with the kids, with other MMA fighters, with Inti. Her last post was over six months before, when she was preparing for the fight with Shona.

Harper holds back angry tears.

TOM (O.S.)
Dinner!

Soren jumps up and runs into the dining room. It takes all Harper's strength to get up off the couch.

73 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, DINING ROOM - DUSK 73 *

Topdown on a plate piled high with Christmas dinner. However, the food is colourless. It seems to be made out of some form of white viscous material.

A fork comes into shot and sinks into the turkey. It doesn't react like meat, rather it squishes like lard. The food is smeared around the plate, melting into puddle of pure fat.

TOM (O.S.)
Bry?

His voice sounds as if it's under water, just as the referee's did in the Echo Arena.

TOM (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Do you want some wine?

His voice floats to the surface until it is back to normal.

Bry looks up from her plate (of perfectly normal food that she's mashed around the dish rather than eaten).

Tom holds up the bottle expectantly. Bry smiles, but again, the smile doesn't reach her eyes.

BRY
Thanks.

Tom fills her glass. She stares at it. It looks like old bath water. We hold on the glass throughout the following conversation.

TOM (O.S.)

By the way, I invited Amy and Marta from work to Friendmas. Neither of them could get enough time off work to fly home for the holidays so they're just kicking about, thought it would be nice.

BRY (O.S.)

Yeah. Nice of you.

TOM (O.S.)

Have you got your Secret Santa gift yet? If not, we can-

BRY (O.S.)

Oh, I forgot. I'm on shift.

TOM

You can't miss it Bry-

SOREN (O.S.)

Mum! Look what I can do. Mum!

BRY (O.S.)

Mmm.

TOM (O.S.)

Soren. Put that down.

SOREN (O.S.)

Mum!

Eventually Bry wrenches her eyes up to Soren. He is balancing a steak knife on the end of his finger. It is impressive and dangerous in equal measure.

BRY

Not bad.

Bang. Bry turns her head to see that Harper has slammed their cutlery down and is storming out of the dining room.

TOM

Harper, finish your dinner.

He sighs. This is exhausting. Soren just looks from his Mum to his Dad. We now see that Bry is once more staring down at her plate, mashing the meal into a disgusting paste. She seems totally unreachable.

Stomp stomp stomp. Harper's footsteps can be heard coming down the stairs and along the hall. They stride past the door to the dining room, coat on.

SOREN

Where are you going?

TOM

Hey, get back here.

The front door slams.

TOM (CONT'D)

Harper!

Tom starts to go after them, then sits back down, defeated.
Soren bursts into tears.

74

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, KITCHEN - DUSK

74

*

Tom scrapes Bry's barely touched meal into the bin. Christmas hits blare from the living room.

Soren stands in the doorway, tears still in his eyes.

Tom sees him and picks him up for a cuddle. Soren rests his head on his Dad's shoulder, still so small.

TOM

Don't worry, little monkey. Mum's just really, really tired from work.

SOREN

She's sad.

TOM

She'll be okay again soon. She's still the same Mum you've always had. She's just really tired at the moment.

But in his eyes: real concern.

75

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - DUSK - CONTINUOUS

75

*

In the hallway, Bry listens to this conversation. She quietly walks down the corridor and up the stairs.

76

OMITTED

76

*

77 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, ENSUITE - DUSK - CONTINUOUS 77 *

Bry looks in the mirror above the sink. She stares at her reflection for a long time.

Suddenly, she punches the tiles next to the mirror as hard as she can. Then again. And again. A barrage of punches until the tiles crack and her knuckles smear blood.

She stops, breathless. Looks in the mirror again as if willing herself to cry, to let something out. But she can't.

Slowly, she takes a toilet roll and begins to wipe the blood off the tiles.

78 INT. HOSPITAL, ICU PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 78 *

Bry and Inti change a vacant bed before the next patient arrives.

INTI
Are you coming to the pub later?

BRY
Ah, no, sorry. Have to get home for the kids.

INTI
Just come for one? It's our Boxing Day tradition!

BRY
Can't. Sorry.

Inti sighs slightly but says nothing. Bry bundles up the sheets, dumps them in a bin and wheels it out of the room.

INTI
Bry-

BRY
I've just got to get something from E.D.

INTI
Can you-

But she's already gone. Inti finishes up the job and then follows.

79

INT. HOSPITAL, NURSES' STATION, MAIN WARD - DAY

79 *

Bry talks to another NURSE at the nurse's station in the bustling Emergency Department. Inti follows, subtly trying to get her attention.

INTI

Hey, Bry?

Suddenly, the external doors burst open and a young FEMALE PATIENT is wheeled in, followed by her MUM, DAD and SISTER, who is sobbing. The PARAMEDIC briefs DOCTORS as they run alongside the gurney.

PARAMEDIC

Suspected suicide attempt, sister found her unconscious in car after the accident, aspirin overdose, head trauma, risk of intercranial haemorrhage, recommend we pump her stomach-

They slam through double doors to take the Patient to surgery. Bry stops the family from following.

BRY

I'm sorry, you'll have to wait here.

PATIENT'S MUM

No, please, let me go with her.

BRY

(sharply)

Best not.

(reassuring)

Let the doctors do their work.

PATIENT'S MUM

What are they going to do to her?

BRY

What did you do to her?

PATIENT'S MUM

What?

BRY

I said, they'll try to save her.

PATIENT'S SISTER

Is she going to be okay?

BRY
They'll try. But you should prepare
for the worst.

The family stand in the hallway, not knowing what to do with themselves. Inti overhears this, frowns.

80

INT. HOSPITAL, ICU PRIVATE ROOM - DAY

80

Later, Inti walks into the Female Patient's room. She finds Bry, alone, staring at the young girl who has tried to take her own life. The Patient's face is badly bruised. Her heart monitor beeps steadily.

INTI
Why'd you tell the family she
wouldn't make it?

BRY
Well, she might not. She took a
massive aspirin overdose and
ploughed her car into a tree. She's
not well, Inti.

INTI
They got to her quick. It's far
more likely she'll be fine in a
couple of weeks.

BRY
Will she?

INTI
What's that supposed to mean?

BRY
Maybe she's beyond help.

INTI
What?

BRY
Nothing. I've got to go up to
cardiolog-

She makes to push past Inti but her friend grabs her arm.

INTI
You're never around anymore. Why is
that?

BRY
Sorry, I've-

INTI
No, don't bullshit me. You're not
okay, so don't tell me you are.

BRY
(rising fear)
Inti, I need to go-

INTI
It feels like you're checking out.
(trying to make light)
Come on. I want my drinking buddy
back.

Bry turns to face her. A side of her we've never seen. A
simmering rage.

BRY
Maybe I don't want to drink with
people who only want to talk about
the fascinating vagaries of
nursing. You want to spend your
free time chatting about how great
it is to be cleaning up the shit
and piss of the elderly and sick,
be my guest, but don't expect me to
join you.

INTI
(stung)
Wow. You know, there are thousands
of people all over the world
queueing up for your job if you
don't want it.

BRY
Well. I'd better get back to it
then.

She's halfway out the door when Inti fires a parting shot -

INTI
I'm going to request to take over
the care of this particular
patient. If you speak to her or the
family again, I'll report you.

Bry says nothing, and walks away.

Midnight. Tom brushes his teeth in the ensuite as Bry takes
off her makeup in the bedroom mirror.

Buzz. A message alert vibration. Then another. Then another. They're coming from Tom's phone in his jeans that lie crumpled on the bed.

Bry, suspicious, picks up the jeans and fishes out the phone. The preview of the messages appears on screen.

They're all from "AMY LEE (Work)"

"Sean told me they let you go."

Next message: "Was it the childcare thing again?"

Bry, shocked that Tom hadn't mentioned this to her, locks the phone. In the blackness of the screen, she sees the reflection of dark clouds gathering overhead.

Before she can become totally consumed by her darkening mood, the toilet flushes. Bry hurriedly replaces the phone and gets into bed. She rolls over and turns her bedside light off, clearly not wanting to confront Tom.

Tom gets his phone out of his pocket, has a quick scroll through his messages and gets into bed.

TOM
Night, my love.

BRY
I'll find cover for tomorrow so I
can come to the party.

TOM
(surprised)
Really? That would be great. The
kids'll be happy.

BRY
(sarcasm)
I'm sure Jess will be delighted.

TOM
Harper.

BRY
Come on. She's not here.

TOM
I know but-

BRY
It's a rejection, she's just
pushing me away. You do see that,
don't you?

TOM
It's not about you, Bry.

Bry is surprised at his tone. Before a fight ensues, Tom switches off his bedside light. Black.

82

INT. PUB NEAR THE BEACH - DAY

82

A traditional pub full of locals enjoying the lull between Christmas and New Year. Bry, Tom, Harper and Soren sit with a big group of friends, just finishing off their meal.

Bry stares at another woman in the group, AMY (30s) at the far end of the table.

TOM
Let's pull the crackers.

Soren grabs his cracker, but Harper doesn't move an inch.

BRY
Harper?

HARPER
No thanks.

Bry holds out a cracker to Harper, who reluctantly pulls the other end.

BRY
You won!

HARPER
(sarcasm)
Yay.

Harper empties the contents of the cracker onto the floor. Bry doesn't have the emotional bandwidth to deal with this act of teenage defiance. Before she can respond, JIM (late 30s, dressed as Father Christmas) starts placing Secret Santa gifts in front of Bry, Tom and Harper.

JIM
Ho ho ho! Merry Christmas!

Harper cringes. Then tears the paper off a book titled 'Queer Art', smiling politely.

JIM (CONT'D)
(to Soren)
Here's your present, young man.

Soren unwraps an amazing sports kite.

SOREN
Yesssss. Can we go and fly it now?

BRY
(happy to escape)
Yeah, come on then. Harper?

Harper considers.

BRY (CONT'D)
Let Dad catch up with his work
friends.
(to Tom)
You can have a nice chat with Amy.

This catches Tom slightly off-guard, but Bry is already walking away. Harper slowly follows Bry and Soren out.

83 EXT. PUB NEAR THE BEACH - DAY

83

Bry has stopped in front of the pub window as the kids walk ahead. Amy has taken Bry's vacated seat and talks to Tom, a warm, sympathetic smile on her face. A premonition.

The sun glares brighter and brighter in the window's reflection, until Bry has to blink and look away.

She walks down the road after her children, the light dull, the cloudy sky slate grey.

84 EXT. BEACH - DAY - LATER

84

Harper watches Bry as she helps Soren launch his kite. Bry comes and sits down next to Harper. They sit in silence.

BRY
The 'Queer Art' book was a
thoughtful gift.

HARPER
Yeah.

BRY
Who do you think it was from?

HARPER
Someone well-meaning.

BRY
You don't like it?

HARPER

Well, it's a bit like when I was 6
and I mentioned once I liked Lego,
and I got 22 Lego sets for my
birthday. There's more to me than
Lego, you know?

BRY

Well come on, Jess-

HARPER

Harper.

BRY

Sorry, Harper-

HARPER

Are you even going to ask me where
I went on Christmas day?

BRY

Where did you go on Christmas day?

HARPER

Alex's house.

BRY

Who?

HARPER

Alex.

(sighing)

Their dead-name is Sara.

BRY

Oh. Right.

HARPER

Not sure why I expected you to
remember that.

BRY

(irritated)

Sorry, Harper. It's hard to keep up
with you sometimes.

HARPER

Yep. Well. You didn't choose me.
You can't choose your blood
relatives. But you can choose your
family.

BRY

Right. And Alex is family?

HARPER

And Jaz, and Issy. They're my family now. They chose me, and I chose them.

BRY

Okay.

Harper, pissed off at this response, waits for more.

HARPER

This is where you're supposed to say, "I choose you, Harper."

Bry stares impassively out to sea.

BRY

I've always chosen you.

HARPER

(mirthless laugh)
Bullshit.

Harper stalks off down the beach.

Bry slumps on the pebbles, scrolls mindlessly through social media. Faintly, on the wind, Harper's voice reaches her.

HARPER (CONT'D)

Mum! Mum! Mum!

She turns to see Harper dragging Soren out of the sea, waves crashing over them. Soren still clutches his (now broken) kite.

Bry leaps up and runs to them, but the damage is done. Harper berates her as Soren sobs pitifully, whining not for her, but for Tom.

SOREN

(inconsolable)
Dad! I want Dad!

HARPER

He nearly drowned. Where were you?

BRY

Soren-

She tries to pull her son into a hug, but Harper wrenches him away from her. He shivers and buries his face in his sibling's coat.

HARPER
(cold)
You weren't there. You never are.

SOREN
(muffled sobbing)
I want my Daddy...

Bry is devastated but has no way to express it.

At that moment, Tom comes running and scoops up Soren, who sobs into his shoulder.

TOM
It's okay. It's okay.

It starts to rain. At first we're not sure if it's in Bry's head, but Tom, Soren and Harper rush back towards the pub. Bry is rooted to the spot - allows the rain to soak her to the bone.

85 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT

85

The orange glow of an LED clock: 4am.

Bry lies in bed, staring at her phone as Tom sleeps. She is reading the T&Cs of her life insurance policy. The policy won't pay out in cases of suicide.

Very deliberately, she opens Google and types: "MMA fatalities".

86 INT. STUDENT FLAT, KITCHEN - DAY [FLASHBACK]

86

12 years earlier. Inti sits at the kitchen table staring at a hand-written letter. She looks devastated, worried, almost tearful, but when we hear the slam of the front door, we jump cut to Inti looking very angry, as if the picture has glitched.

Bry, worryingly thin and pale, walks into the kitchen. Inti looks up at her accusingly, but Bry avoids eye-contact. She fills the kettle and puts it on.

INTI
(harsh)
Where have you been?

BRY
(joking)
Ask your Dad.

INTI

Bry-

BRY

(breezy)

Just went for a drive. Didn't feel
like going to uni today.

Inti stares at her judgmentally.

INTI

I found your note.

Bry clocks the letter in her hands. She immediately jumps to
the offensive.

BRY

That wasn't *for* you-

She snatches the letter.

BRY (CONT'D)

You know what, Inti, I don't owe
you shit, so stay out of my
business. It's fine for you, you
never do a single thing wrong, do
you? You're so fucking perfect-

Inti stands up, staring intensely at Bry as she rants. She
launches herself at Bry and... pulls her into a hug. Bry
tenses, tries to push her away, but Inti won't let go. She's
sobbing.

INTI

You're not alone. You're not alone.

Bry softens. Melts. And then finally breaks down.

Inti and Bry hold onto one another in the kitchen, crying
their hearts out.

87 EXT. T.K.O MMA GYM - DAY

87

Back to the present. Bry walks up to the gym in her nurse's
uniform, partly covered by a coat, Soren in tow. She takes a
deep breath, and walks inside.

88 INT. T.K.O MMA GYM - DAY

88

Bry walks into the gym. She couldn't look more incongruous.

She has a vision of herself, punching away at the bag that hangs in the middle of the room. Every fighter's portrait on the wall behind has become a photo of her.

Suddenly, Greg's harsh voice rips her from her reveries.

GREG (O.S.)
What do you want?

Bry turns to see Greg emerging from the back office.

BRY
Hi Greg, nice to see you too.

Greg turns on the false politeness.

GREG
(sarcastic)
Lovely to see you again.
Delightful. What've you been doing
with yourself?

She gestures to the uniform, the kid.

BRY
What's it look like?

Greg is unimpressed.

GREG
Not much.

She looks irritated but doesn't disagree.

GREG (CONT'D)
D'you know what, I'm surprised you
have the guts to show your face in
here after Glasgow.

BRY
She won on a cheap shot-

GREG
That's pure pish. Your head was
somewhere else. Your heart wasn't
in it. You know it's true and
that's why you **ve not** been
training. Now get the fuck out of
my gym.

*

*

BRY
Greg-

Greg turns to go back to his office.

BRY (CONT'D)

I want to come back.

Greg doesn't even turn around.

GREG

Why? So you can let me down again?

BRY

I've been offered Morrigan at Wembley against Isa Janssen.

Greg stops in his tracks.

BRY (CONT'D)

I'm still number two in the country. I can beat her.

He turns to her. Scoffs.

GREG

D..you actually believe that?

*

BRY

Yes.

That was a test. Greg nods. Then turns away and walks to his office.

GREG

6am tomorrow. Let's hope you ain't got too flabby.

89 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT

89

Tom wakes in the night to find the bed empty. He looks to the window to see a light on in the garden.

90 EXT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARDEN - NIGHT

90

Tom finds Bry training furiously in the cold night.

*

TOM

You said Shona would be the last one. You promised.

She doesn't even throw him a glance.

BRY

This will be the last one.

TOM

No Bry. No, this is not happening.

Bry stops. Turns to look at him but doesn't move.

BRY

We need the prize money, don't we?

Tom is wrong-footed.

BRY (CONT'D)

When were you going to tell me you got fired?

TOM

How did you-

BRY

Does it matter?

TOM

I... I didn't want to add to your stress.

BRY

Good job.

TOM

Can you come in please?

BRY

No.

Tom lets out a sigh of frustration.

TOM

You know, I might still have a job if you took your fair share of the childcare.

BRY

Don't try to put that on me. You're the one who's put our home at risk.

TOM

It's not- I'll get another job. Jesus. Why does everything have to be a crisis with you?

She looks at him as though he is incapable of understanding.

91 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, LIVING ROOM - EVENING

91

We track in on Tom & Bry's TV.

12th March 2020. The Prime Minister, BORIS JOHNSON, addresses the nation.

BORIS JOHNSON

This is the worst public health crisis for a generation. Some people compare it to seasonal flu. Alas, that is not right. Owing to the lack of immunity, this disease is more dangerous. And it's going to spread further and I must level with you, level with the British public, many more families are going to lose loved ones before their time.

We reverse to find Tom, Harper and Soren watching the news together.

92 INT. HOSPITAL, ICU NURSES' STATION - DAY

92

At the hospital, all nurses have been called to a departmental meeting. Fran addresses the group.

FRAN

So, as many of you may have gathered, the unit is setting up a sealed coronavirus ICU. We are asking for volunteers to take shifts on the wards. You'll be provided with the PPE that we have and we will support you as best we can, but at present there are no additional resources to deal with this so we will need to work together...

Inti and Bry stand apart from one another - the rift still not mended. Whilst Inti's face is etched with concern, Bry just listens blankly.

93 INT. HOSPITAL, ICU CORRIDOR - DAY

93

*

Later. Inti, still wary but shocked at the news and needing her friend, approaches Bry at the nursing station. Bry doesn't look up from her paperwork.

INTI

Hey.

BRY

Hi.

INTI

How have you been?

BRY

Fine. What do you want?

INTI

Pay rise and a holiday in the
Canaries would be nice.

Bry doesn't crack a smile. She drops the folder she was
working on into a tray and makes to leave.

BRY

Yep.

INTI

Wait, Bry. Are you going to sign up
for the coronavirus ICU?

Bry finally looks at Inti.

BRY

I don't have time.

Inti nods, half to herself.

INTI

I guess you have to think about
your family.

BRY

I guess you're lucky you don't have
one.

Bry walks off. Inti is stunned by her callousness.

94

INT. T.K.O MMA GYM - NIGHT

94

Bry is smashed in the face by another FIGHTER. Greg watches
as she spars, shaking his head.

*

GREG

What the fuck was that? Maybe you
are too old. You're embarrassing
yourself.

BRY

I know how old I am, Greg. I don't
need you to tell me.

She gets hit again. She puts her hands up to stop the fight.

GREG

What're you stopping for?

Bry gets up in Greg's face.

BRY

I need you to support me or I'll
train elsewhere. Can you do that?

GREG

(on the back foot for
once)

What d'you think I'm doing?

BRY

Good. One last fight. Win or lose,
it'll be over.

She taps gloves with the Fighter and lamps him. Greg smiles.

GREG

Kill him!

95

INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD.../ CORRIDOR - DAY

95

*

We follow a ventilator as it's being pushed down an ICU corridor. It clears frame to reveal Inti in her PPE. She wears gloves, a bin bag acting as an improvised apron, a tight-fitting dust mask (the kind you might get from a builder's merchants), a face shield and a hair cover that looks like a shower cap.

*

*

Fran, who looks like she is in a space suit, is at the nurse's station, hastily entering data into an outdated PC.

*

*

FRAN

We're running out of beds. And
we're out of the good masks until
Friday.

INTI

Okay. Are you off now?

FRAN

Unlikely. Manpreet quit last night,
there's no one to cover.

INTI

Okay.

FRAN

Can you take these four?

She hands her a stack of case-files. Inti is appalled.

INTI

Four?!

FRAN

What do you want me to say? Top
one's end-of-life, so you'll only
have three in an hour or so. Happy?

Inti shakes her head, frustrated. Fran instantly apologises.

FRAN (CONT'D)

Sorry. I'm on hour 14 and been
holding a wee for the last 3.

Inti nods her forgiveness. She grabs the files and heads to the wards. We follow her through the chaos.

As she prepares to enter a patient's curtained off cubicle, she hastily puts on an extra set of gloves and an apron. A bodybag is wheeled past her to the mortuary. She doesn't bat an eyelid.

She goes into the cubicle. CARL BLOOMWELL, a male patient in his 70s, lies unconscious on the bed, hooked up to a ventilator. Miss Nair is by the bedside.

MISS NAIR

Okay, let's make him comfortable.
His wife is waiting outside, she's
aware that she's here to be with
him as he passes away. Can you
bring her in, please?

Inti nods. We follow her out into the waiting room.

INTI

Elenor?

ELENOR BLOOMWELL (70s) in full PPE, looks up from her magazine. She smiles and pops it in her bag.

ELENOR

Hello!

Inti is confused by her upbeat tone.

INTI

Hi... how're you doing?

ELENOR

Good, good.

They walk back to the cubicle. Inti gives her an extra mask to put on, then pulls the curtain across so they have some privacy.

MISS NAIR

Hello again, Elenor. Would you like to sit down?

ELENOR

I'm fine, thank you Doctor.

She starts gathering up Carl's things, cheerfully.

MISS NAIR

So, as we discussed on the phone, we are going to turn off Carl's ventilator, which means that he will stop breathing and pass away.

ELENOR

No no. I'm taking him home. Come on, Carl. Get dressed.

Nair looks from Elenor to Carl to Inti, not sure what to do.

INTI

Mrs. Bloomwell. I'm afraid Carl isn't going to recover from the virus. He's not coming home.

ELENOR

Don't be silly.

(to Carl)

Up you get. Want to miss rush hour.

She continues to pack his things, not looking at her husband. She surveys a bowl of slightly withered grapes by his bedside.

ELENOR (CONT'D)

(to Carl)

Do you want to take these grapes?
They look like they're on the turn.

Inti puts a hand on her arm. Elenor reacts like she's been scalded, wrenching her arm away.

ELENOR (CONT'D)

(screaming)

Don't touch me! We just want to go home. Why are you being like this?

Inti and Nair look on in horror.

Fran suddenly bursts in.

FRAN

I'm so sorry to interrupt but we need you right now in 14.

INTI

I can't-

Fran gives her a look - this is life or death.

FRAN

Now.

Inti, with an apologetic backwards glance at the Doctor, runs up the corridor to the next ward with Fran.

They burst into Bay 14, where another COVID-19 PATIENT (60s) is flatlining. Inti starts hand-pumping air into the patient's lungs with a ventilation bag, whilst Fran and another NURSE hook the bag up to oxygen. The patient is stable for now, but Inti can't stay.

Inti runs back to Carl and Elenor, dodging other medics in the hallway, but as she passes by another ward she hears an alarm.

We're into another curtained cubicle, where the ventilator beeps to alert staff that the COVID-19 PATIENT's blood oxygen has dropped dangerously low. Inti calls out to no one -

INTI

I need some help in here!

A voice from a couple of bays away - another nurse, FRAYA (20s) assails her.

FRAYA (O.S.)

Someone help me first!

(desperate)

Please!

Inti is torn, but runs into Fraya's cubicle. Fraya looks extremely young, and extremely frightened. Her PATIENT is flat-lining.

FRAYA (CONT'D)

I... Oh God. His blood pressure-

Inti works on the patient as she barks at Fraya.

INTI

Get Fran to 23 - blood oxygen drop.

Fraya is frozen in fear.

INTI (CONT'D)

NOW!

Fraya runs off.

INTI (CONT'D)

Fuck.

96 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD.../ CORRIDOR - DAY

96 *

Bry passes by the entrance to the unit. It's sealed off so she can't go in, but when a doctor rushes out she catches a glimpse of the chaos through the double doors.

Inti is crossing the corridor, passing from one ward to the next. They lock eyes as the doors swing shut.

97 INT. HOSPITAL, MAIN WARD ENTRANCE - DAY

97

Inti is on the phone.

INTI

(in Arabic)

I wish I could but they need me at the hospital. Yes, it's okay. Well, it's hard but, I'm glad to help. I know. I miss you too. Love to Dad and Naima. I will. Stay safe. Bye.

She hangs up before her voice begins to waver. Bry walks out of the hospital, with barely a nod at Inti.

Inti's drawn back to her phone by an alert from Instagram. A photo from the Gym's feed - Bry training with Greg. She swipes to the next. They're laughing together.

Inti's eyes fill with angry tears.

98 OMITTED

98

99 OMITTED 99

100 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT 100

The glow of another mobile lights up a face. This time, it's Bry. She is scrolling through numerous articles about contenders who have died from injuries sustained in the ring.

She looks at injury photos, studies brain trauma scans and protective gear malfunction. She becomes an expert on how to lose your life in the cage.

She zeroes in on a quote from the loved one of a victim: "He just wouldn't tap out."

A message alert from GREG: "Fight's off."

BRY
What the fu-

She sits up. Tom stirs slightly but doesn't wake.

Another message: GREG: "Word from Mikey - all live events cancelled bc coronavirus. Announcement in morning."

BRY (CONT'D)
Fuck. Fuck.

She navigates to a news app, where she was reading an article about a man killed in the cage. She flicks to the homepage and is confronted with the rising coronavirus death-count.

BRY (CONT'D)
Fuck.

She clicks on an article: "Death toll rises as NHS staff hit hardest by coronavirus." She clicks and reads.

101 EXT. ROADSIDE DINER - DAY [FLASHBACK] 101

12 years earlier. Young Bry drives into a service station in her old hatchback. Manic Street Preachers' 'A Design for Life' blares from the tape deck.

102 INT. ROADSIDE DINER - DAY [FLASHBACK] 102

Young Bry sits at a plastic table on a plastic chair, and eats a big bacon sandwich. She is in heaven, savouring every bite.

*

A GRUFF TRUCKER at the table next to her slouches over his meal. Bry turns to him cheerfully.

YOUNG BRY
This is my last meal.

The Trucker nods. Either he doesn't understand English or he doesn't want to engage.

Unperturbed, Bry smiles and turns back to her food.

103 INT. ROADSIDE DINER, TOILETS - DAY [FLASHBACK] 103

In the toilets, Bry looks into the mirror. Wordlessly says goodbye.

104 EXT. HOTWELL ROAD - DAY [FLASHBACK] 104

Bry guns along the road, approaching the iconic Clifton Suspension Bridge. Once more, the Manics' 'A Design for Life' plays on the stereo. She smiles beatifically.

105 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD - DAY 105

Inti is putting in a heavy shift in the Coronavirus ICU. The intensity only seems to climb.

She walks into a curtained-off bay -

INTI
Morning Chris-

- to find that the patient she expected to see is no longer there. The bed is neatly made. There is only one place her patient could be.

Inti takes a moment. Tears form in her eyes.

The sound of the curtain scraping back. Inti turns to see Bry, in full PPE. Inti pulls herself together.

INTI (CONT'D)
What are you doing here?

BRY
I got a bit bored of the normal
ICU. Not enough death.

Inti nods, half smiling. Turns back to the bed to hide her tears. Even through two layers of PPE, Bry knows her friend well enough to know she's not okay.

BRY (CONT'D)

Inti?

Inti shudders with uncontrollable emotion. Bry pulls her into a hug.

BRY (CONT'D)

Sorry for being a cunt.

Inti breathes. Hugs her back. Then gives herself a shake.

INTI

Let me get my shit together.

BRY

Yeah, get your shit together,
Jesus.

That gets a snotty laugh out of Inti.

INTI

I thought you were sorry for being
a cunt?

BRY

I am. And actually, it's quite nice
for me to hold you whilst you sob
for a change. I'd like you to cry
more often, if anything.

Inti chuckles. She's got her friend back.

106 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD - DAY [MONTAGE]

106

Inti and Bry work together in the ICU, tending to patients,
checking vitals; administering medication.

They keep going and going and going from one curtained bay to
the next, a tormented montage of hopeless patient after
hopeless patient.

Sweat drips into Bry's eyes. The dust mask cuts into her
face. She pulls it back slightly to take a breath but a
colleague shoots her a reprimanding glance so she pushes it
back into place over painful sores, wincing, and carries on.

107 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARAGE - NIGHT

107

The garage shutter is pulled up and Bry staggers in. She's
made up a narrow camp bed in the corner, with a kettle and
mini-fridge beside it. She collapses onto the rickety bed.

Soren appears at the door to the kitchen, opening it just a crack.

BRY
No! Out, Soren. It's too dangerous.

SOREN
But I just-

BRY
Shut the door.

Soren closes the door. A pause.

SOREN (O.S.)
Night night.

Bry looks heartbroken.

BRY
Wait. Are you okay?

SOREN (O.S.)
Yeah. You don't need to worry about us.

She goes to the door. Kneels down and leans her head against the bottom panel.

BRY
Night night. I miss you.

108 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, KITCHEN - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 108

Soren leans his head against the door.

SOREN
Miss you too.

109 INT. HOSPITAL, ICU NURSES' STATION - DAY 109

Another gruelling shift. Inti and Bry, in full PPE, cross paths briefly at the nurse's station.

INTI
Can you check in with Fran?

BRY
Staffroom?

INTI
No, she's in Bay 37. On a
ventilator.

BRY
Shit.

110 INT. HOSPITAL, STAFF CANTEEN - DAY

110

Bry and Inti eat lunch. They sit 2 meters apart in silence,
conserving their energy.

BRY
The food's actually getting worse.

INTI
Impossible.

BRY
Taste that.

She gives Inti her sandwich. Inti takes a bite. Her face
contorts in disgust.

INTI
Not great.

BRY
Tastes like metal, right?

INTI
I can't taste the metal. But I am
getting notes of raw sewage.

Bry screws up her napkin and dumps the mostly uneaten
sandwich in the bin.

111 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD - DAY

111

Inti and Bry change Fran's cannula in silence. She lies face
down on the bed, in a coma. It's an unnerving sight that the
nurses are all too accustomed to. The steady breath of the
ventilator fills the silence.

INTI
You need to get better faster Fran,
we're not coping well without you.
You're being a bit selfish, to be
honest-

Suddenly Inti has a coughing fit inside her mask. She rights
herself. Bry and Inti's eyes meet. Worried.

112 INT. HOSPITAL, SMALL ROOM - DAY 112

Bry sits in a windowless room, in isolation. She still wears full PPE. A printed 'result' in her hands.

"Nucleic acid amplification test PCR SARS-CoV-19: POSITIVE"

Her breath speeds. Gets louder and louder until it fills our world with panic.

113 EXT. RESIDENTIAL STREET - EVENING 113

Bry drives home from work. She looks shell-shocked. The sound of clapping, whistles blown, pots being banged with wooden spoons starts up.

Bry looks out of the window to see people opening their windows and standing outside their doors, clapping for carers. The cacophony grows.

Bry looks on the verge of tears.

114 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARAGE - NIGHT 114

Bry lies face down on her camp bed. Her eyes open, staring into nothingness.

The remains of numerous junk food items lay scattered about the floor along with quarter-eaten plates of the meals Tom has cooked for her. Two or three remain completely untouched. Every item of food is the same waxy white colour, as if cast out of lard.

Oblongs of sunlight from the narrow windows move across the walls, but Bry doesn't move an inch.

It gets dark. Her phone pings. She ignores it. It pings again. And again.

Bry finally peels herself off the pillow and reaches down from the bed, rummaging in the detritus on the floor. She finds her phone under the half-eaten crisp packets and chocolate wrappers. She brings the phone up to illuminate her face in its cold glow.

When she unlocks the phone, it opens on the last article she viewed: "LOSS OR CHANGE TO SENSE OF TASTE NOW RECOGNISED AS KEY CORONAVIRUS SYMPTOM"

She navigates to her messages.

"JANINE (Work): We've had to put Inti on a ventilator."

"JANINE (Work): I'm sorry Bry."

"JANINE (Work): It doesn't look good."

Ping. An image. Inti lies in an ICU bed. She has her eyes taped shut, wires and tubes all over her.

Ping. "JANINE (Work): Do you want us to video call you if she reaches end-of-life?"

The expression on Bry's face remains impassive. She drops the phone. It falls to the floor with a faint clatter.

Then she flinches slightly as something small and white falls onto her face and bounces off. We might realise it's a hailstone, we might not. Another hits her on the cheek. Another hits her forehead.

Suddenly she is battered by a torrential hailstorm. She curls into a ball on the bed to try and protect herself, but she is pounded brutally by the stones. The hail smashes glasses, splatters food up the walls, knocks objects off shelves. Bry curls around herself, eyes closed tight, jaw clenched, every muscle in her body taught with agony.

115

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARAGE - PRE-DAWN

115

Pale pre-dawn sky shimmers through the narrow elevated windows. A dawn chorus begins faintly in the distance.

The storm has passed, leaving the room partially buried in hailstones. The bed, in particular, is barely visible under a deep pile.

The door to the kitchen creaks open a crack and a strip of warm tungsten lights up the room. Tom puts a plate of food down on the floor.

TOM
(softly)
Bry?

No movement from the pile of hailstones where the bed used to be.

TOM (CONT'D)
Bry? Are you awake?

From inside the hailstone igloo, we see Tom's hazy silhouette in the doorway. The light from the kitchen makes the tunnel through the hail sparkle slightly.

BRY

Hmm.

TOM

Bry, I'm so proud of you.

We see one of Bry's eyes peering out of the crystalline mound.

BRY

I gave Inti Covid.

TOM

What? No. There's no way you could know that. She could have got it from any patient-

BRY

I did. I took risks and I gave her Covid. She's going to die. Because of me.

TOM

Bry-

BRY

You need to leave. I could still be infectious.

TOM

It's fine-

BRY

Tom, leave. For the kids.

Tom nods.

TOM

Okay. See you tonight. And please, eat something.

He waits for a reply. None forthcoming, he gently shuts the door.

Bry's one visible eye closes.

116

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARAGE - LATE AFTERNOON

116

Warm golden hour light casts shapes on the garage wall. The hailstones have partially melted, becoming more translucent. Ice drips from every surface. A symphony of drips.

Bry is still on the bed. Several more plates of uneaten food are clustered around the door.

Her phone rings. With every ounce of strength she has, Bry pushes her hand through the hail, which scatters everywhere as she reaches down to retrieve her phone.

Caller ID: "GREG"

Surprised, she sits up, cascading hail onto the floor.

BRY
Hello?

GREG (O.S.)
(on phone)
Fight's back on.

BRY
How?

GREG
No audience, restricted crew,
you'll have to test and quarantine.

BRY
I've just had Covid. I'm immune.

GREG
You weak from it?

BRY
No.

GREG
You kept up your training?

We pull back. The room is now clear of hail, but it's a shit-tip.

BRY
Of course.

GREG
Okay. Fight's in three weeks.

BRY
I'm out of isolation in four days.

GREG
Good.

He hangs up. The spark in Bry fires again. She looks at her dismal surroundings, seeing the mess as if for the first time.

117 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARAGE - VARIOUS [MONTAGE] 117

A music-driven montage of Bry's preparation for the fight.

- She cleans up the garage - bagging up trash and scrubbing down every surface.

- She trains, prison style, in her cell.

- She lies in bed looking at the photo of Inti in ICU.

- Quarantine release day. Rather than going into the house, she pulls up the shutter to the street. Dawn sunlight kisses her face.

118 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - DAY [MONTAGE] 118

- Bry trains with Greg, driving herself harder, faster, ever more brutally.

- They spar, grapple, box - she is 100% focussed on the fight.

119 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD - DAY [MONTAGE] 119

- Bry, in full PPE, walks through the ward to Inti's bedside. She holds her hand. *

120 INT. CHEMIST 1 - DAY [MONTAGE] 120

- Bry buys 2 boxes of aspirin.

121 INT. CHEMIST 2 - NIGHT [MONTAGE] 121

- Bry buys 2 boxes of aspirin.

122 INT. CHEMIST 3 - DAY [MONTAGE] 122

- Bry buys 2 boxes of aspirin.

123 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, ENSUITE - NIGHT [MONTAGE] 123

Bry pops aspirin pills out of their blister packs and packs them carefully into a pill box.

124 EXT. SOUTHAMPTON DOCKS - GOLDEN HOUR [MONTAGE] 124

Bry sits on the deserted dockside at sunset. It is eerily quiet, all the bars, cafes and shops shuttered for lockdown.

Bry hand-writes a letter.

We catch a glimpse of the sign off - "I know you can never forgive me. But I will love you all, forever and ever."

She puts the letter into an envelope and addresses it to "Tom, Harper and Soren". She seals it and places it carefully into a side pocket of her kit bag.

She looks out to sea as the sun sinks beneath the horizon.

END OF MONTAGE.

125 OMITTED 125

126 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - DAY 126

Bry and Greg spar. A confidence and viciousness in Bry like nothing we've ever seen. She is aggressive, getting into his space, getting points, getting out.

Seeing an opening in his defence, Bry tackles Greg to the mat. She twists his arm up behind him with her left arm and legs, and punches him relentlessly in the head with her right. She screams, terrifyingly. Greg is defenceless against her savage assault.

GREG

Fuck! Argh!

From the sidelines, Jamie is alarmed by Bry's brutality.

JAMIE

Bry! Bry!! Stop!!

Greg taps out but Bry doesn't stop. Jamie drags her off him. She is breathless and shaking with adrenaline. Something animal in her has surfaced.

Greg immediately springs up. He is bleeding from the nose, left eyebrow and mouth. He spits his gum guard, throws it across the room and advances on Bry.

She tries to get away but it's too late, he grabs her - and pulls her forehead to his, screaming in her face.

GREG
Yeeeeesssss!

He pulls back. He's delighted. This is the first time we've seen Greg happy. It might be the first time Bry's seen him happy too.

GREG (CONT'D)
You're ready. You're fucking ready!

They scream in each other's faces, laughing, shaking, pure adrenaline.

Jamie watches this display. He rolls his eyes and walks off, shaking his head.

127 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, KITCHEN - NIGHT

127

Bry watches her family eat. The radio is on in the background, the news detailing the current COVID-19 death toll.

She looks down at her own tiny portion of protein and salad. Realises she can't even face that, and doesn't even make the pretence of pushing the food round her plate.

TOM
(to Bry)
How are you feeling about tomorrow?

BRY
Yeah, good.

SOREN
What's tomorrow?

TOM
(to Soren)
Mum's got her fight, remember? She has to go and isolate in a hotel.

SOREN
Oh yeah.

HARPER

(to Tom)

Do you enjoy being a house husband?

BRY

Can you just be nice tonight?

TOM

(to Harper)

I love it Harper, because I get to spend all my time in your wonderful company.

HARPER

(to Bry)

Unlike you. Taking the job on the Covid-ward must have seemed like the perfect opportunity for you, Bryony. And now you're away for another fight. Perfect, isn't it? You don't have to spend any time with us at all-

TOM

(getting irritated)

Harper, that's enough-

But he stops in his tracks when he sees Harper's expression switch from defiance to regret. He turns to look at Bry: she has tears in her eyes.

Not knowing what else to do, he starts collecting the dishes.

TOM (CONT'D)

Shall we watch a movie? Soren, it's your turn to choose.

But Soren is also staring at his mother. Bry and Harper stay locked into each other's gaze.

Finally, Bry gets up and heads upstairs. Harper looks to Tom, guilty and worried.

128

INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, HALLWAY - NIGHT

128

Late that night. Bry stands outside Harper's room, and gently pushes the door open. Harper sleeps with their back to the door.

129 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, HARPER'S BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 129

Bry creeps in and looks around at the way Harper has decorated the bedroom. Images ripped from magazines, prizes they've won at school, drawings they've made.

Bry gazes down at Harper's sleeping form.

BRY
(whispering)
I love you. I love you. I'm so
sorry. I love you.

Her eyes shimmer with tears.

130 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, SOREN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT 130

Bry stands over Soren's bed. He sleeps peacefully. Bry cries silently as she watches him. She puts a hand over her mouth to stifle her sobs.

Bry leaves the room and slowly pulls Soren's bedroom door shut. The thin blade of light illuminating Soren's angelic face recedes and finally, extinguishes.

131 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, HARPER'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS 131

Harper, now facing the door, listens to their mother's footsteps make their way along the corridor to the bedroom. Harper is confused and deeply troubled by Bry's behaviour.

132 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT 132

Tom and Bry lie in bed, Bry with her back to him to hide her emotional state. Her tears pour into the pillow.

Tom reads. Stops. Looks over, trying to find the right words. He watches her breathing and knows she's awake.

Tom puts down his book and strokes her shoulder. Bry doesn't respond. He withdraws.

He turns off his bedside light, closes his eyes.

Bry stares into the darkness, wishing she could tell him how sorry she is.

132A INT. BRY'S CAR - DAY 132A *

Bry drives Greg up to London.

GREG

The first time we met, I could see
there was something wrong with you.
I mean, in the head.

BRY

Is this meant to be a pep talk?
Because it needs work.

GREG

It was obvious you were starving
yourself. Torturing yourself. But
you had this spark in you too. I
got that, I could work with that. I
didn't understand the other thing.
But I do now.

BRY

I know.

GREG

I'm as fucked in the head as you
are, now.

BRY

More, probably.

GREG

Do...one.

*

They share a little laugh. Greg sobers.

GREG (CONT'D)

My brain wants me dead. You know
that feeling?

*

Bry nods. A lump suddenly in her throat. She indicates to
turn off the M25, following the signs for Central London.

BRY

We're almost there.

Greg stares out of the window.

GREG

You've got to give this fight
everything, Bry.

BRY

I will.

134 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - DAY 134

Pale dawn light illuminates Bry as she sleeps. She wakes up alone, in a strange room. For a second, she struggles to remember where she is.

A characterless, minimalist hotel room.

Bry gets out of bed and immediately drops to the floor to start her workout. Push ups, pull ups, stretches, squats.

135 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - DAY - LATER 135

Bry is tested for COVID-19 by a nurse in full PPE.

136 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - LATER 136

On her phone Bry scours Inti's Facebook page. Lots of "get well soon" messages. Some written almost as though she were already dead.

Her brother, MO, has posted an update on her wall 3 hours before: "Inti is still in critical condition. Will keep you all updated."

Bry turns her phone to standby, then turns it back on and calls Tom.

BRY
Sorry, did I wake you?

137 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 137

Tom, face half obscured by the pillow. He's pissed off.

TOM
You know you did.

138 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 138

Bry rests the phone against her ear.

BRY
Sorry. I miss you.

TOM (O.S.)
(through phone, tutting)
Bry...

BRY
I just wanted to hear your voice.

TOM (O.S.)
Can you hear it saying "I need to
take the kids to school in 3
hours?"

BRY
I love you, Tom.

139 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 139

Tom sighs, frustrated.

TOM
Yeah? Then why won't you stop, Bry?
Why can't you just be with us?

Silence from the phone as Bry tries to find the right words.
Tom starts to get impatient.

140 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 140

Bry's voice is heard, but her lips don't move. We hear the
thoughts she can't bring herself to say.

BRY (V.O.)
Because without fighting, I'm an
average nobody. Worthless.
(anger)
I'm the fucking girl next door.

TOM (O.S.)
(through phone)
Bry?

141 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 141

Tom listens to Bry's breath, increasingly frustrated.

TOM
Hello?

142 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 142

BRY (V.O.)
At school: average. As a nurse:
below average. As a mother:
Destructive. As a wife...

TOM (O.S.)

Okay, I'm going to hang up.

Finally, Bry speaks.

BRY

It's the only place I feel free.

White noise on the line.

BRY (CONT'D)

I know that sounds selfish-

TOM (O.S.)

Yeah. It does. It's not fair on the kids... It's not fair on me.

BRY

I know.

TOM (O.S.)

Bry. Let it go.

BRY

I can't.

TOM (O.S.)

Fuck sakes, Bry. It doesn't define you.

BRY

But fighting is such a big part of-

TOM (O.S.)

Not fighting. Pain. Do you really think your suffering makes you special?

BRY

No, I-

TOM (O.S.)

(cold)

Because it doesn't.

Bry's stomach drops.

TOM (O.S.) (CONT'D)

I'm done, Bry. I'm sorry. It's over.

BRY

Tom-

But Tom's already cut off the call. Bry blinks, in shock.

143 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 143

Tom holds the phone to his chest. He stares at the ceiling.

144 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 144

The screensaver on Bry's phone: a photo of Tom, Inti, Bry and baby Harper, 10 years before. Bry stares at her phone. A tear trickles down her cheek. Then she nods. It's for the best.

145 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - NEXT MORNING 145

Tom wakes up to find Harper staring down at him.

HARPER

Dad. Can we talk?

Tom blinks. The night's events come flooding back. He nods.

146 INT. CORPORATE HOTEL ROOM - DAY 146

The clock reads 11am. Bry has ordered a big dirty burger from room service. But her sadness overwhelms her enjoyment and she gives up after a few bites.

147 INT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, BEDROOM - DAY 147

Tom packs. Shouts into the hallway.

TOM

Kids. We need to leave. Now.

He closes the suitcase.

148 INT/EXT. ALEXANDRA PALACE - DUSK [ARCHIVE MONTAGE] 148 *

A music-driven hype-reel for the Tyrell/Janssen fight made surreal by the total lack of audience.

- Aerial establisher of the historic Alexandra Palace. No cars on the road or planes in the sky.

- Posters advertising the TYRELL v KIELHOTLZ fight are plastered with 'NO PUBLIC ENTRY' stickers.

- A discarded facemask in the gutter.

- Ticket offices are closed.
- Bars have their shutters down.

149 INT. ALEXANDRA PALACE, LOCKER ROOM BATHROOM - NIGHT 149

Bry examines her ageing face in the locker room mirror. The mirror faces another floor-to-ceiling mirror, so her image repeats infinitely in both directions.

She takes out a leather toiletries bag. Inside, we catch a glimpse of the suicide note addressed to 'Tom, Harper and Soren'. She takes out the pill box which is full of aspirin. Downs a handful with water.

She backs away from her reflection until her back rests against the mirror behind her. Takes a deep breath, psyching herself up. Leans forward and, with all her considerable strength, throws her upper body back against the mirror. Her head hits the glass with a gut-wrenching thud. She does it again. And again. On the third hit, the mirror cracks. She reaches up and touches the back of her head. Blood on her fingers. Turns to the mirror, her broken image repeating into the distance.

She blinks. Shakes her head slightly. A likely concussion. Looks into the unbroken mirror again. Focussed.

150 OMITTED 150

151 EXT. CLIFTON SUSPENSION BRIDGE - DAY [FLASHBACK] 151

12 years earlier. A river rushing beneath us. Rain falls. The Manic Street Preachers 'A Design for Life' reaches us faintly on the wind.

Young Bry stands on the outer edge of Clifton Suspension Bridge, looking down at the water below. Seemingly at peace.

152 INT. ALEXANDRA PALACE - NIGHT 152

That same peaceful look on Bry's face as the soothing sound of the river continues. As we pull back, we reveal that she is standing at the entrance to the stadium. The sounds of the river turn into the sounds of a crowd.

Bry walks out into the light. She grins from ear to ear. Unfurls a Union Jack which flutters out behind her, glowing in the stage lights. The river/crowd roars-

Silence. When Bry takes in the vast stadium, it is totally empty. This strange scene feels somehow perfect for her. She is truly ready. Ready to fight, ready to die.

Suddenly, we are in the ring. ISA JANSSEN (30) stands opposite her. Bry gives her a strange smile. Isa is slightly unnerved, but doesn't let it throw her.

The bell. The fight is fast, brutal. Bry performs brilliantly, giving it everything - a kamikaze mission.

The pair are evenly matched but neither is giving in. One moment, Isa has the upper hand; the next, Bry has her in a choke hold.

The fight has a fragmented, subjective feel - we are close in on the women's struggles; their grasping fingers and sweating brows. Without the usual crowd noise we can hear every ragged breath. So much of the match is spent in a bitter embrace, grappling on the mat; desperately trying to force the other to submit.

Finally, Bry finds herself pinned. She drops her guard just enough for Isa's blows to rain down heavy, but not enough for the REFEREE to stop the fight.

Time slows and we creep in to read the resignation in her eyes. The blows keep coming, bursting her eyebrow, nose, lip. Blood spatters the mat.

A shadow crosses her face. Inexplicably, it begins to rain.

Bry's life flashes before her eyes: As a baby, sleeping in someone's arms; as a toddler, finger painting; paddling in the sea...

BRY (V.O.)

I've been so lucky to have had such
fantastic times in my life.

Back to the stadium. Bry's eyes stare glassily into space. Fat droplets of rain bounce onto the mat, washing her blood into a river...

Her life flashes before her eyes: As a 3 year old, dressed for her first day at school; shyly looking around the school yard; watching TV alone...

BRY (V.O.)

At times, I've been so happy I
could explode.

Back to the stadium. Bry's eyelids begin to flutter. Rain pours heavier.

Her life flashes before her eyes: As a 5 year old, flying around a merry-go-round; eating candy floss; playing in rock pools at the beach...

Back to the stadium. Bry's eyes roll back. Rain pounds her face.

BRY

All my love, forever... and ever...

Her life flashes before her eyes: As a 7 year old, curled up on the couch; walking in the rain; looking out to sea...

BRY (CONT'D)

...And ever.

Suddenly, a peircing scream.

HARPER (O.S.)

Mum!

Back to the stadium. Bry's eyes suddenly snap open.

We see what Bry sees: through the storm, amongst thousands of empty chairs, she zeroes in... on Tom and Harper. They're really there. They came to support her. Harper's face is a mask of fear for their mother. She shouts again-

HARPER (CONT'D)

Mum!

Suddenly, tears fill Bry's eyes. Tom and Harper sparkle in a glittering haze. She smiles through her tears. And taps out.

The rain instantly stops.

Isa leaps up and offers Bry a hand, pulling her into a heartfelt hug.

ISA

Great fight. You okay?

Bry grins a slightly dazed and bloody smile as she gazes into her child's eyes, happy despite the fact that it's her opponent's hand the referee has raised. She sleep walks to the cage entrance.

Greg meets her at the gate, pulling her into a hug.

GREG

Fucking hell, Bry. How are you still standing?

But in this moment, Bry isn't looking for Greg's approval. She pushes past him and runs into her family's arms. Harper holds Bry tight, terrified they'll lose her again.

HARPER

You didn't win.

Bry looks into Harper's eyes.

BRY

It's not about winning. It's about fighting for as long as you can.

She pulls her eldest close again. Tom puts his arms around them both. They hold one another as we move up and away, until they are dwarfed by the huge empty stadium.

153 OMITTED 153

154 INT. HOSPITAL, COVID ICU WARD - DAY 154

SUPER: ONE YEAR LATER.

Close on the face of a WOMAN IN HER 60s, who looks not unlike an older Bryony, pixelated slightly as if filmed on a screen. She is crying.

Bry, in full PPE, stands with other nurses and doctors by the bedside of an ICU PATIENT, tubes and wires coming out of them.

They have just turned off the patient's respirator. Everyone is masked, ragged and emotionally exhausted. Bry holds an iPad, on which a devastated family watches their loved one fade away by video link.

A tear trickles down Bry's cheek. Flatline.

A hand on Bry's shoulder gives her a little rub of support. Bry turns and hugs Inti. She made it through.

155 INT. T.K.O. MMA GYM - DAY 155 *

Pictures of Bry hang alongside Greg's on the walls, along with cuttings about her recent wins. Bry and Inti spar. This is not the punishing regime leading up to a fight - they're letting off steam, enjoying themselves.

Greg, repainting the back wall, looks over with disapproval.

GREG

I've seen 90 year old women at the
bingo...**lamp** each other harder than
that.

*

BRY

It's called "having fun" Greg, you
should try it some time.

Greg rolls his eyes. Inti and Bry go back to their sparring.

156

EXT. BRY & TOM'S HOUSE, GARDEN - DAY

156

Bry sits alone in her garden on a beautiful sunny day. The
radio is on, and the newsreader relays the latest Coronavirus
death-toll, but she isn't listening.

Instead, Bry takes in the sounds of the neighbourhood. A dog
barks. A plane passes overhead. Birds sing. She notices a
blackbird's nest in their apple tree. The bird perches on her
eggs.

Tom comes out with an iced coffee for her. She takes it.

BRY

Thanks.

They sit in comfortable silence for a moment.

BRY (CONT'D)

So. My phone just reminded me it's
been exactly a year since the
Janssen fight.

TOM

I love it when your phone reminds
you of things I've tried to wipe
from my memory.

BRY

You know... when I was on the mat,
I saw my life flash before my eyes.

TOM

Why would you make it worse?

BRY

Tom, listen. At first, I thought it
was my life...

We see flashes of her life again - As a baby, sleeping in
someone's arms; as a toddler, finger painting; as a 3 year
old, dressed for her first day at school;

as a 5 year old flying around a merry-go-round; as a 7 year old, looking out to sea...

BRY (CONT'D)

But it wasn't.

We see flashes of her life again, but this time, we show that what we saw before was Bry's point of view - a baby sleeps in Bry's arms; a toddler finger paints with Bry; a 3 year old, dressed for her first day at school so Bry can take a photo; a 5 year old sails around a merry-go-round, fingers reaching for Bry; a 7 year old looks out to sea... And is joined by Bry. They hold hands.

BRY (CONT'D)

It was Harper's.

Tom just looks at her. His hand creeps into hers. Smiles at the irony that she can still surprise him.

BRY (CONT'D)

Do you remember that I video-called you the night before the fight?

TOM

(with regret)

Yeah.

BRY

You said I wasn't special.

TOM

No-

BRY

Just let me finish. You were right. I think I'm finally at peace with that. I have you and Harper and Soren. I'm making a difference at work-

Tom shakes his head.

TOM

That's not what I said. I said your suffering doesn't make you special.

BRY

Same thing-

TOM

No. I meant, your *suffering* isn't what makes you special.

(MORE)

TOM (CONT'D)

What you've achieved in martial arts, or nursing isn't what makes you special. None of that has anything to do with why you're so special. I wish you could see that.

Bry looks away, holds back tears. Tom pulls her into a hug. The kids emerge from the house to join them.

SOREN

(to his parents)

Get a room.

Bry chuckles. She is finally in the moment with her family, soaking up the sun, truly enjoying her food.

She takes a bite of a strawberry. The juice drips down her chin. Soren wipes her face with a napkin. Harper laughs at this strange role reversal.

Suddenly, clouds roll in. It starts to rain. No one reacts, evidently, Tom and the kids don't notice the storm.

Bry's phone rings. 'Mum'.

Bry breathes deep and raises her face to the rain. Finally at peace.

She takes the call, her mother's voice crackles onto the line.

MUM

Hello love.

Bry smiles.

THE END.